Transcript from National Grid Natural Gas Long-Term Capacity Report Public Meeting[1]

March 23, 2020

Coordinator: Welcome...

Coordinator: ...and thank you for standing by. At this time, all participants are in a listen-only mode until the question-and-answer session of today's conference. At that time, you may press star 1 on your phone to ask a question.

I would like to inform all parties that today's conference is being recorded. If you have any objections, you may disconnect at this time.

I will now turn the call over to John Bruckner. Thank you, sir. You may begin.

John Bruckner: Well, thank you, (Denise). My name is John Bruckner and I'm the president of National Grid New York. Welcome to our public meeting on National Grid's Long-Term Natural Gas Capacity Report for Suffolk County, which was originally scheduled to be in person in Brentwood, fulfilling a provision of the company's November 2019 agreement with New York State.

[1] Provided by MyMeetings.

In that agreement, National Grid committed to researching and publishing a report that offers potential long-term solution options to address downstate New York's recognized natural gas constraint issue. National Grid issued this report in February 2020 and scheduled a series of public meetings to hear from our customers and other stakeholders and understand their expectations and opinions on how we together can solve the energy challenges that face our region.

Because of the outbreak of the coronavirus, and in consideration of the wellbeing of the public and our employees, we've had to cancel the public face-to-face meetings, except for our first one on March 9 that took place in Hicksville, Long Island.

To provide an alternative way, to help you understand the report and our findings, we scheduled a series of virtual meetings to achieve the same objective, to share the information and answer any questions you may have on each of the options as well as hear from you directly through an oral comment period.

Before we get to the run of show and how this session will work and I can provide you some context and other important information. New York has seen dynamic economic growth in the downstate region, expanding residential and nonresidential building space and thousands of oil-to-gas conversions over the last ten years.

These factors have resulted in a substantial increase in the demand for natural gas, placing stress on our existing gas network and threatening National Grid's ability to meet our customers' needs when the demand is at its peak.

This leaves little room for error in the face of an unplanned supply interruption or other contingencies. As part of the November 2019 settlement agreement with New York State that lifted the moratorium on new gas connections imposed in May 2019, we're taking measures to ensure we have enough supply for the winters of 2019 through 2020 and 2020 through 2021 including increasing reliance on compressed natural gas, or otherwise known as CNG trucking, when needed to meet peak demand.

Beyond the next two winters, however, continued growth in the demand for natural gas creates a challenge that must be addressed. The long-term natural gas capacity (unintelligible) presents ten options to solve that challenge. It's important to note that the long-term solution options we're presenting and the various combinations of these options working together have different implications for how long we continue to rely on CNG trucking to meet peak demand and whether we might have future restrictions on new gas connections.

Also of note, low common solutions will be an important part of reaching the longer-term clean energy goals. While formerly not part of tonight's presentation, National Grid is partnering with third parties to develop renewable natural gas solutions, exploring hydrogen blending and palleted gas to help carbonize the gas system. We're also piloting geothermal heat pump solutions with partners like NYSERDA, and we continue to implement clean energy solutions throughout our entire service territory in the US with solar, wind, battery storage and EV stations.

All this information can be found on our Dedicated Long-Term Capacity Report web site, ngrid.com/longtermsolutions. In addition to the full detailed report, the web site also features a shorter summary report to better help the public understand the options.

To further aid in transparency and understanding, we have updated the report on the web site to include a technical appendix that lays out even more of the details of our analysis and assumptions as well as estimates of how the cost of the different options would impact our customers over time.

The Web site also features other methods of sharing your feedback beyond tonight's public meeting. You can take a survey to share your view on the various options, and I encourage you to do so. You'll also find instructions on multiple ways you can submit comments directly to the New York State Public Service Commission.

Also on the Web site you can find information about our financial assistance programs for residential and small business customers who were inconvenienced because of the moratorium last year. Please visit the Web sites for more information.

So let's begin tonight's meeting with some guidance on how the session will work. We'll begin the session with a short overview video. After that video, we'll play short videos on each of the options in the following three categories -- large infrastructure, distributed infrastructure and non-infrastructure. After each video option we'll open up the phone lines for questions specifically related to that option.

This is the Q&A portion of the meeting, your opportunity to ask clarifying questions on each option. We have subject matter experts on the line to answer any specific questions you have on that option. I want to be clear; this is not the time to express your views and opinion. This will only be dedicated to clarifying questions on that respective option. When your line is open, we'll ask for your name, zip code and affiliation, whether you're a customer or

part of an organization. The Q&A will be recorded, transcribed and submitted unabridged to the New York State Public Service Commission.

And then finally we will open the lines for you to have an opportunity to provide feedback and express your views during the public oral comment period. When you come on the line, we will ask you for your name, zip code and affiliation. And then you can make your statement. We will be limiting all comments to two minutes. Your comments will be recorded, transcribed and submitted, again, unabridged to the New York State Public Service Commission.

One final note -- key to this meeting is a respectful of exchange of information and ideas. While there may be some disagreement on how we get there, we are all here to solve the energy - solve for the energy solutions that address the needs of the current future generations and we look forward to hearing from you on how best to meet those challenges. So thank you and now let's take a look at the overview video.

((VIDEO)) Overview video is available here: https://ngridlongtermsolutions.com/

Man 1: (Unintelligible) has led to a challenge in meeting customer energy needs when temperatures - National Grid provides natural gas to 1.9 million customers throughout Brooklyn, Queens, Staten Island and Long Island. Our customers rely on us to meet their needs every day, especially on the coldest days and demand for natural gas is at its highest. Growth in peak demand has led to a challenge in meeting customer energy needs when temperatures drop.

We've recently taken steps to ensure we have adequate natural gas supply for this winter and next winter. Beyond that, however, there needs to be a long-term solution to balance natural gas demand and supply.

National Grid is committed to working with its customers and with New York State to collaborate on a long-term solution that closes the gap between natural gas demand and supply and ensures we can provide for the needs of current and future customers.

We've provided New York State and its residents with a comprehensive report exploring the options to close the gap between natural gas demand and supply. We've evaluated the reliability, cost, environmental and community impacts of each option.

Long-term options to solve the natural gas capacity constraint can be grouped into three broad approaches -- building out a large-scale infrastructure project sized to meet the projected gap between natural gas supply and demand, using a combined approach of smaller sized distributed infrastructure solutions to increase natural gas supply along with other options geared toward reducing demand, or relying on various new infrastructure solutions to aggressively reduce the growth of natural gas demand so it can be met by the existing natural gas infrastructure.

Creating a comprehensive long-term solution will likely require a combination of options working together. You can learn more in the report on our Web site or at any of the public meetings we're hosting across downstate New York. The people of downstate New York have an important voice in helping identify the right solution to meet its energy needs today and for years to come.

Feedback can be shared at our public meetings and via our Web site. We want to know what options you think should and shouldn't be part of the long-

term solution. Your feedback is valuable and it will be an important part of future decision making.

Thank you for your time, your interest and for being part of our collaboration for a safe and reliable energy future.

((END VIDEO))

(Bill): Over to you, John.

John Bruckner: All right. Thank you, (Bill). All right. Now we'll play the Options video. The first two will focus on large infrastructure options, offshore LNG deep water port and an LNG import terminal. Once we come back, we'll take questions on these options.

Please get your questions ready and dial star 1 to get into the queue. When it's your turn, the operator will open up the line and ask you for your question.

So let's play that first video, set of videos.

((VIDEO)) All videos are available here: https://ngridlongtermsolutions.com/

Man 1: Offshore LNG deep water port involves the installation of an offshore buoy connected to one of the existing undersea pipelines that currently supply the downstate New York region. Connected to this buoy would be a floating storage and re-gasification unit, an LNG bulk delivery ship. This ship can store more than 3 million dekatherms of LNG and then vaporize it for injection into the pipeline to accommodate peak demand and potentially help meet daily demand during the year.

Unlike a gas pipeline solution, this option stores a finite amount of natural gas and is replenished via ship-to-ship transfers. There are two potential locations where this could be installed -- one on the Long Island Sound and the other in the Atlantic Ocean off the rockaways. (Unintelligible) impacts should be minimal given the distance from the shore. Each location would be capable of delivering 4,000 dekatherms per day capacity. If this option comes to pass it's highly reliable.

What would the impact be on the environment? During construction, the impact includes disturbance of the sea floor, decreased water and air quality, increased sedimentation, noise and waste generation. Once operational, the floating storage and regasification unit and refueling tanker can be expected to generate stack and cooling water emissions.

Greenhouse gas, GHG emissions from an LNG system present a climate impact 10% to 15% greater than a standard natural gas solution. Given its offshore location, the community impacts of this option should be minimal. We expect full implementation of this option within six to eight years. If you've read the report, you know each option carries some execution risks and considerations.

Until this infrastructure comes online, we would have to retain our compressed natural gas trucking operations for periods of peak demand, and we'd have to implement a series of incremental energy efficacy demand response and electrification measures to further reduce demand. If these measures do not predictably meet target volumes or timelines before the infrastructure comes online there would have to be restrictions on new customer connections.

We estimate the total cost of this option, including the infrastructure and the demand side program to be 1.9 billion in our low demand scenario and 2.22 billion in our high demand scenario.

Woman 1: A liquified natural gas or LNG terminal involves building the infrastructure necessary to accommodate LNG carrier ships including an LNG receiving facility, onshore storage, regassification and transportation components. Such a facility would be able to accommodate peak demand and help meet daily demands during the year. It would provide 400,000 dekatherms per day of natural gas capacity.

This is a highly reliable option. However, it is more vulnerable to severe weather than similar floating LNG and LNG barge options we've presented. This is an option used all over the world, and National Grid has experience with LNG facilities both here in the US and in the UK. What would the impact on the environment be? It would be equivalent or slightly higher than those associated with the offshore LNG deep water port and higher than pipeline development.

Greenhouse gas emissions would have a climate impact of 10% to 15% greater than a standard natural gas solution. There would be significant impact to the community resulting from construction and operation. And before it ever came to pass, it would require changes to or a waiver of existing New York State law that limits land storage of natural gas. Pending this necessary change to the law, we estimate the timeline for this option to be five to six years.

If you've read the report, you know each option carries some execution risks and considerations. Until this infrastructure comes online, we would have to retain our compressed natural gas trucking operations for periods of peak

demand, and we'd have to implement a series of incremental energy efficacy demand, response and electrification measures to further reduce demand. If these measures do not predictably meet target volumes or timelines before the infrastructure comes online, there would have to be restrictions on new customer connections.

We estimate the total cost of this option, including the infrastructure and the demand signed programs, to be 2.46 billion in our low demand scenario and 2.70 billion in our high demand scenario.

((END VIDEO))

(Bill): John, that concludes Video 1.

John Bruckner: All right. Thank you. So as a reminder, please dial star 1 to ask your questions, and I'll hand it back over to the operator.

Coordinator: Thank you. I do have a few questions. One moment. The first question comes from Kim Fraczek. Please state your affiliation and zip code.

Kim Fraczek: Hi. Can you hear me?

(Bill): Yes, we can.

Kim Fraczek: Great. I'm the director of Sane Energy Project, and I just have a question for you regarding the presentation portion that you just gave to us. Are you aware that New Yorkers worked for three years in a campaign to defeat a liquified natural gas port off the coast of New York called Port Ambrose in 2015?

John Bruckner: So (Tony), I'll ask you to answer that question, please?

(Tony): Sure, I'd be happy to. Hi. Yes, we are aware of that one, and there was another one in the Long Island Sound broad water. And correct, we understand that they were both denied state permits. Actually they were permitted by (FERC).

One of the issues though is it's - those were a different business model. They were much larger projects than what we're discussing. Well, the ships might have been the same size. There was a lot more volume that they were talking about.

But regardless of either of those, mainly what we're doing is just showing you, you know, these are options that are available to meet this need. So this is the first of many options that you'll, you know, see tonight. Thank you.

Kim Fraczek: May I have a follow-up question?

John Bruckner: Sure, Kim. Go ahead.

Kim Fraczek: Great. Thank you. So given the fact that Governor Cuomo and also the Army Corp of Engineers denied a liquidized natural gas port for New York because there was such an overwhelming opposition against liquified natural gas in New York, why would you possibly be proposing this for us if there's an overwhelming opposition to it and that we know that we can meet our demands with renewable energy demand management and energy efficacy?

(Tony): So...

John Bruckner: So (Tony), I'll take that, and - (Tony)...

(Tony): ...okay, very good. Thanks, John.

John Bruckner: ...I'll take that. That's fine. And, you know, I - again, as (Tony) had indicated, the idea here is to present all of the options that are available and then, you know, assess all of these options. So in the spirit of transparency and putting out there what the options are, we didn't go over this.

We recognized in the past it may not have been successful in a different venue, but again, it's an option that is - that's available and, you know, it's important that we hear everyone's input about it, and we certainly have recognized yours. So thank you for your questions. And operator, I'd ask that we go to the next question.

Coordinator: That comes from JK Canepa. Please state your affiliation and zip code.

JK Canepa: Yes, my name - can you hear me? Can you hear me?

John Bruckner: Yes, JK, I think you said.

JK Canepa: Thank you so much, yes. My name is JK Canepa and I'm with - also with the Sane Energy Project. So I have a question that completely mystifies me. It's been 86 years since the New York City metropolitan area has sustained a temperature of 0 degrees for 24 hours straight.

However, in your report, that's what you seem to be planning for to take care of the city, keep us warm when the temperature drops to 20 - for 24 hours to 0 degrees. Can you tell me why you came up with that number? It absolutely is counterintuitive.

John Bruckner: So JK, I think first off is - you know, thank you for the question and, you know, if you have any - a comment about it or need clarification, you can certainly use the time at the end for your public comment. (Cameron), I'll ask if you wanted to address this particular issue.

(Cameron): So I think in our report we provide a lot of information around Design day and around, you know, the design day that we use. There's also a further explanation around the need for gas on - within the Design day in periods of even higher demand. So what we would call the Design hour, which, you know, has additional capacity needs. So, you know, I would just sort of refer to the description that we have on Design day and Design hour and the needs that we have.

Man 2: That wasn't the question. Hey.

(Cameron): And then, you know, would welcome any - you know, any submissions that, you know, people have as far as written feedback.

JK Canepa: Well, we'll submit the (unintelligible).

Man 2: You're evading the question.

John Bruckner: I'm sorry. Is there someone else that's registered on the call?

Man 2: You're evading the question. You didn't answer the question.

John Bruckner: I'm sorry. Who is this?

((Crosstalk))

Man 2: …the temperature.

John Bruckner: I'm sorry.

Man 2: I'm part of - I'm...

John Bruckner: Operator, who...

Man 2: ...part of this public meeting. I'm part of this public meeting, sir.

John Bruckner: I'm sorry, I - operator, is this JK still? It sounds...

Coordinator: One moment...

John Bruckner: ...like someone else...

Coordinator: ...please.

John Bruckner: ...joined the call.

JK Canepa: Hello. Can you hear me?

John Bruckner: Yes.

JK Canepa: You can hear me?

Coordinator: One moment, please. Michele Fox, your line is open. Please state your affiliation and zip code.

Michele Fox: Michele Fox, 11218, affiliation's Sustainable Event Alliance and Sane Energy Project, zip code 11218. Am I supposed to ask a question or am I supposed to make a statement?

John Bruckner: Yes, Michele, at this point in time, as we talked about at the start of the meeting, we showed the video of the large infrastructure project for the LNG and the platform. So at this point in time, if you have any specific questions about that particular project, you should certainly ask the question for that.

If you have a comment that you want to make, we do want to get through all the options to be respectful of everybody's time and get to the point where you can submit an oral comment, which would be later after the three video sessions that take place.

So if it is a comment, we'd be happy to hear it. If it's not specific to this particular part of the presentation, I would ask that you wait till the end and give your oral comments.

Michele Fox: So my question is, with National Grid buying $32 million for falsely claiming that we needed the fossil fuel infrastructure?

John Bruckner: Okay. So again, it's - we'll take your comments at the end. We'll be happy to do so. If there are questions with respect to the SME that we have on the line, (Tony), with respect to large infrastructure projects, we'll take that question now. Otherwise, you can save your comment and question until the oral comment period. Thank you.

Operator, we'll take the next caller.

Coordinator: I have no other questions at this time.

John Bruckner: All right. Then we'll go to the next video option. The next option will focus on another large infrastructure option, the Northeast Supply Enhancement Project. Please get your questions ready with respect to the Northeast Supply Enhancement Projects and dial star 1 after the video. So (Bill), let's start the video, please.

((VIDEO))

Man 3: The Northeast Supply Enhancement or any SE project involves the construction of an interstate pipeline by Williams Companies Incorporated to transport natural gas from Pennsylvania to New York to New Jersey via the Raritan Bay and lower New York Bay. The pipeline would include approximately 23.5 miles, approximately 17 in New York of underwater pipeline to the Rockaway Peninsula in Queens.

It would provide a downstate region with 400,000 dekatherms per day of natural gas capacity. This option is extremely reliable and fundamentally resistant to above-ground weather events. The environmental impact of construction would be similar to offshore LNG deep water ports, albeit over a larger geographic area.

This impact includes disturbance of the sea floor, decreased water and air quality, increased sedimentation, noise and waste generation. Ongoing operations will have a much lower effect on the environment and greenhouse gas emissions are expected to be 10% to 15% lower than any of our LNG options.

Commute (unintelligible) impacts would be minimal with most of the construction happening offshore. There is some onshore construction in New

Jersey in the Brownfield sections, and Williams' existing footprint. In the future, the carbon fuel pipeline material (unintelligible) will allow hydrogen to be transported, helping significantly assist with carbon reduction goals.

Assuming the option receive New York State and New Jersey permit approval by June 2020, we estimate this project can come online by December 2021, because this has the fastest estimated infrastructure timeline and, once in place, has very high reliability.

It provides the highest degree of certainty that there will not be restrictions on new customer connections, and once the infrastructure is online we would be able to mothball compressed natural gas trucking and reduce some contracting peaking supplies, which would eliminate a source of supply with higher emissions and provide us with some contingency capacity. This option would cost $1.82 billion in the low demand scenario and $1.83 billion in the high demand scenario.

((END VIDEO))

(Bill): John, that concludes Video Number 2.

John Bruckner: All right. Thank you, (Bill). And as a reminder, dial star 1 to ask any of your questions with respect to the Northeast Supply Enhancement Project. We have our subject matter expert on the line, Liz Arangio, to answer any of your questions with respect to the Northeast Supply Enhancement Project. So, operator, we'll go to the questions.

Coordinator: The first question comes from Annie Wilson. Please state your affiliation and zip code.

Annie Wilson: New York Environmental Law and Justice Project, zip code NY 10007. So my question is, for both the Northeast Supply Enhancement Project, as I was looking online, and what is the LNG. So why are the efforts made by your corporation to reduce the demand - it's foolish and certainly immoral to be increasing the infrastructure for fossil fuels in any way. How do you justify that? That's a two-part question. Thank you.

John Bruckner: So, Annie, I'm going to ask you again, if it's - if you have a question specific - we have a subject matter expert on the line with respect to the Northeast Supply Enhancement Project. If you have a comment that you want to make or you want to submit questions...

Annie Wilson: I just put in my question which is very clearly, "What have you done to reduce the demand?" That's the question. And the second part is about the morality of this matter, which is the increase of the fossil fuel infrastructure, two-part question. I hope I'm clear enough. Thank you.

John Bruckner: Okay, Annie, your question is clear, not germane to the Northeast Supply Enhancement Project, so...

Annie Wilson: You could apply both those questions to both these issues. So apply it to the Northeast Supply Enhancement Project given that you're focusing only on that right now, but I want you to know that I tried three times to raise my hand in the previous part of this session relating to the pipeline, to the LNG, okay? Thank you.

John Bruckner: Okay. So, Annie, again, I'm going to ask you what is your question with respect to the Supply Enhancement Project?

Annie Wilson: Yes, what efforts have your corporation made to reduce the demand? That's Part 1. And Part 2...

John Bruckner: Okay...

Annie Wilson: ...how do you justify the immorality or the morality of increasing the infrastructure for fossil fuels in this time of climate disruption?

John Bruckner: Okay. So a couple of things. First of all, with respect to your question about energy efficacy, there's a non-infrastructure project that you can ask questions about shortly that will go through as well as within the report there's a number of assumptions that are made with respect to energy efficacy.

I do want to get, operator, to any question with respect to the Northeast Supply and Action Project and give the (Andy) the opportunity later on to make her oral comments with respect to any concerns that she has.

Coordinator: Next question comes from (Barbara Hertel). Please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Barbara Hertel): I am part - my name is (Barbara Hertel). I am part of Sane Energy and Food and Water Watch in New York City. And my zip code is 11211 in beautiful Brooklyn. My question is that demand for gas is really going on a downward trend right now. So one of my questions is why do we need to have the Williams Pipeline and any of these other projects which increases our demand on Fossil Fuels?

John Bruckner: All right, (Barbara). Hey, (Cameron), I'd ask if you could address that question with respect to what the demand is showing on natural gas.

(Cameron): Yes, sure.

(Barbara Hertel): Well...

(Cameron): What we've done in our report is lay out what we have as a demand forecast for natural gas from 2020 out through 2035. We've seen that historically over the last ten years that in downstate New York we've had growth of approximately 2.4% a year in natural gas demand. And in the report, we outline a number of drivers, key drivers as to why that - how that growth has been happening.

As we project going forward, we do see that the growth in natural gas demand will be slower. And we've outlined what we see as the key drivers of that, and a big piece of that is the increases in energy efficacy, some increases in demand response, some increases in electrification.

And so when we look at that, it leads us to two scenarios that we've presented a low and high demand range, and we see that the growth over the next 15 years will be significantly slower, and the projection is 0.8% to 1.1% a year growth over that time period. So we do expect that the growth rate will come down, but we are also continuing to see growth in demand.

John Bruckner: Okay, operator, can we get the next question, please?

Coordinator: Certainly, that comes from (Sade Nickels), Consumer National Grid. And please state your zip code.

(Sade Nickels): My zip code is 11215 and I'm just going to echo a lot of the questions that I felt like were not answered by National Grid which is that - what is the long-term plan for decreasing consumer need for natural gas in the first place?

John Bruckner: I'm sorry. I didn't get your name. And (Cameron), can you answer that?

(Sade Nickels): My name is (Sade Nickels).

John Bruckner: (Sade). Okay. Thank you.

(Sade Nickels): Yes.

(Cameron): Yes, so again, I think in the report we've tried to lay out a couple of things. So there is historic programs that we have done, National Grid working in conjunction with the state of New York, with downstate New York that have had an impact on increases in energy efficacy.

(Sade Nickels): Specifically what has National Grid done to decrease the need for natural gas?

John Bruckner: So again, (Sade) - I think you said your name was (Sade). A couple of things. I really want to focus this session. You're more than welcome to participate in, you know, our comments section, but we do have subject matter experts on the line to address your specific questions.

Woman 2: She's asking a question.

John Bruckner: And if you can just wait until that stage of the meeting...

(Sade Nickels): Excuse me?

John Bruckner: ...we can get through all the options. Maybe some of your questions may be answered, but I would appreciate it if we could wait until that stage of the meeting and ask any questions that you might have or comments. Okay?

Thank you. Operator, any other questions on the Northeast Supply Enhancement Project?

Coordinator: The next question comes from (Margo Gregory). Your line is open.

(Margo Gregory): Hi. Thank you for taking my call. My name is (Margo Gregory). I live in Brooklyn from New York. I'm from New York and my affiliation is with Sane Energy Project. I have a master's degree in education and I live in Brooklyn. My zip code is 11205.

John Bruckner: Thank you.

(Margo Gregory): My question to you is - well, it's really a two-part question. As an educator, I'm speaking to you from this standpoint. Are you aware of how incredibly difficult it is to get on a call in a meeting like this? And secondly, are you aware of the global impact of methane gas, nitrous oxide and carbon dioxide on global heating and the current global climate change crisis? Those are direct questions with regard to this project. I would love to hear your answers.

John Bruckner: So (Margo), that - is it (Margo)?

Coordinator: Yes, that was (Margo).

John Bruckner: (Margo), the first thing is I know how difficult it is to get on a call and have it in this fashion, so we originally set up these meetings to be face-to-face and meet publicly with you at a location that's convenient to you in this case.

Unfortunately we're all dealing with the impact of the coronavirus and that's just not able to be done at this time. So we certainly wanted to respect that

agreement and settlement with New York State and have these meetings in the next best available way, which was by having it done virtually such as this.

I think we've all been asked to step up with respect to how to perform business in all facets of business virtually in light of the coronavirus. So I think that's your first part.

As far as your second part, again, I don't think it's a specific question to the (unintelligible) project, but again, if you have a comment with respect to any of those issues, I would ask respectfully that you wait until the comment section and submit your comment there. If you have any questions, you could also submit them through the Web site that I mentioned earlier and I'll go through again later on the call. Thank you, (Mora).

((Crosstalk))

Coordinator: There are no other questions.

John Bruckner: You want to go to the next video? Why don't we go to the next video? And this way we can get through the videos as well.

((VIDEO))

Woman 3: A peak liquified natural gas or LNG facility is one of our distributed infrastructure options. It would involve construction of a new LNG peak shaving facility plant and related infrastructure, like what we already have in Greenpoint, Brooklyn and Holtsville, Long Island. This is a highly reliable option and is in use throughout the United States. We have 12 of these facilities across our Massachusetts, Rhode Island and Down State New York service areas.

But to get this option up and running would require a change to or waiver of New York State law that limits land storage of natural gas. Once online, this option can potentially provide up to 100,000 dekatherms per day to meet periods of peak demand.

The environmental impact for this project would be moderate, including decreased air quality, pollution of stormwater and other runoffs, disruption to natural resources and habitats, noise and waste generation. (Unintelligible), however, have a smaller footprint compared to a larger infrastructure (unintelligible) options.

This (unintelligible) option would have to be (unintelligible) within (unintelligible) community, most likely within an industrial zone. This option would have greenhouse gas emissions similar to our other LNG options and 10% to 15% higher than standard natural gas solutions. But remember, this option would only run to meet peak day demands.

Assuming changes or a waiver from current New York law, it's estimated a new site would be operational in five to six years. This option does carry some execution risks and considerations until it comes online. Because this solution only fills part of the gap between demand and supply and is estimated to take five to six years to come online, it would need to be paired with a series of near-term and ongoing incremental energy efficacy demand response and electrification measures.

If base demand reduction measures do not predictably meet target volumes or timelines, there would have be restrictions on new customer connections. In addition, unless demand reduction can predictably exceed targets, we would have to retain our compressed natural gas trucking operations for periods of

peak demand. We estimated total cost of this option, including both the infrastructure and the demand side programs is $1.49 billion in our low demand scenario and $2.54 billion in our high demand scenario.

Man 3: Liquified natural gas, or LNG, barges are one of our four distributed infrastructure long-term options. This option involves the purchase and construction of one or more specialty LNG barges with vaporization equipment on board. These barges would be towed to locations to allow them to transfer LNG from a variety of land and sea-based sources and inject vaporized gas into the existing onshore pipeline.

This option can provide potentially up to 50,000 dekatherms of peaking capacity per barge. If used in tandem, total supply would double to 100,000 dekatherms per day. This is a reliable option and the barges can be strategically placed in multiple locations, assuming permit approvals.

The environmental impact would be similar to the offshore LNG port solution but at a smaller scale with disturbances of the sea floor, decreased water and air quality, increased sedimentation, noise and waste generation. The other only construction required is a new pier and a short pipeline to an existing onshore connection.

In addition there would be visual impacts to water views during the winter, and there may be loss of waterside recreation use in the immediate area due to the size of the barge system and security perimeter developed during the siting process.

We estimate the total implementation time for this project can be five to six years. Because this solution only fills part of the gap between demand and supply and estimated to take five to six years to come online, it would need to

be paired with a series of near term and ongoing incremental energy efficacy demand response and electrification measures to reduce demand and completely close the gap.

If the demand reduction measures do not predictably meet target volumes or timelines, there would have to be restrictions on new customer connections. In addition, unless demand reduction can predictably exceed targets, we would have to retain our compressed natural gas trucking operations for periods of peak demand. The total estimated cost of this option, including both the infrastructure and the demand side program, is 1.36 billion in our low demand scenario and 2.42 billion in our high demand scenario.

((END VIDEO))

(Bill): John, that concludes the video.

John Bruckner: All right. Well, thank you again. Operator, I'll ask that we open up the line and please dial star 1 if you have any questions around the natural gas facility and the LNG. We have a subject matter on the line, Brian Gray.

Again, I remind them if you have questions about those videos and those options, I just want to remind our audience tonight that if you have questions around this particular option, please hit star 1. There's been a number of questions about energy efficacy. Later on we will have a few subject matter experts that talk about energy efficacy and demand side management. So if you have questions about that please wait until that point.

So operator, can we open up the lines?

Coordinator: The first one comes from (Ira). Please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Ira): Hi. I'm (Ira). I'm with 350 Brooklyn, and my zip code is 11222. In that last presentation there was talk of habitat destruction and the destruction of the sediment floor and I would like you to elaborate more on which animals will be affected, the number of animals to be affected and the extent of deaths you can predict based on your projections.

John Bruckner: Brian, I would ask if you have any of that information. If not, we can certainly record the question and look to provide some of that information in the study. So Brian, do you have anything on that?

Brian Gray: Yes, sure, John. What I would say is that in order to site that facility, we would need to go through an extensive waterway suitability assessment and those kinds of issues that you discussed, rightly so, would need to be assessed as part of, you know, an environmental impact study, you know, throughout that process.

So while we're very early in development at this point and we're just looking to present these as potential options, you know, those kinds of answers would need to be studied, and well-studied, during the further development of any project.

(Ira): Okay. Thank you.

John Bruckner: Thank you, (Ira). Operator, next question.

Coordinator: The next one comes from Alex Dillon. Please state your affiliation and zip code.

Alex Dillon: Hi. Alex Dillon. Long Island Progressive Coalition, zip code 11516. I live on the south shore of Long Island. My question's actually about the Northeast Supply Enhancement Project. I was on the queue previously but didn't get to ask it. Is - has this project not been rejected twice, both by New York State and New Jersey, and how is the current proposal different from the twice rejected by two states proposal? Thank you.

John Bruckner: All right. You know, in the spirit of transparency, Liz, I would ask that we can answer that question, please.

Liz Arangio: Sure. So, yes, the project has been approved by the (FERC). It has right now experienced, as you noted, in New York and New Jersey, some rejection of permits. But right now the project is as it was filed with the (FERC). That is the project right now that we're looking at as we described here up to 400,000 dekatherms a day. So that part of it has not changed. It was really the...

John Bruckner: Yes, the only thing...

Liz Arangio: Yes. It was approved...

John Bruckner: ...I would add to that, (Alex), is, again, it - we're really just trying to put forth all of the options and then certainly take your feedback and your questions back when we do the final assessment and evaluation with New York State. So I certainly - I appreciate your question and respect your opportunity to ask it.

(Bill): Hey, John. This is (Bill).

John Bruckner: Operator, please - yes?

(Bill): Let's move on to Video Number 4.

John Bruckner: Okay.

((VIDEO))

Woman 3: Clove Lake transmission move project is one of our distributed infrastructure long-term options. It would involve construction of approximately eight miles of new 30-inch field transmission main across the burrow of Staten Island. It will help our ability to take more gas through the (unintelligible) station and ultimately move more gas across our system to supply constrained areas.

When complete it can provide approximately 70,000 to 100,000 dekatherms per day of baseload capacity to support daily demand and it would be used to support the system year-round. This is a historically very safe and reliable method of transporting natural gas. Most of the environmental impact would come from construction. It would involve installation of a new gas main across sections of a heavy populated urban environment and would possibly impact multiple highways and/or small water crossings during installation.

Because of the proposed (unintelligible) we would need a mitigation plan to minimize disruption to residents' businesses and traffic. (Unintelligible) operation (unintelligible) the impact will be minor as little ongoing maintenance will be required. Greenhouse gas emissions will be comparable to similar gas mains in the (unintelligible) distribution system. Once operational, this option will have lower emissions than the liquified natural gas options or compressed natural gas trailers and trucking.

(Unintelligible) indicate that this option could be in service by November 2025 at the earliest, making the timeline five-plus years. Because this option

only fills part of the gap between demand and supply, it is estimated to take five plus years to come online, it would need to be paired with a series of near term and ongoing incremental energy efficacy demand response and electrification measures to reduce demand to completely close the gap.

If the demand reduction measures do not predictably meet target volumes or timelines there would have to be restrictions on new customer connections. In addition, unless demand reduction can predictably exceed targets, we would have to retain our compressed natural gas trucking operations for periods of peak demand. The total estimated cost of this option including both the infrastructure and the demand side programs is 1.57 billion in our low-demand scenario and 2.63 billion in our high-demand scenario.

Man 3: The Iroquois Enhancement by Compression Project is one of our distributed infrastructure long-term options. It would involve the construction of the additional compression facilities to increase capacity on the Iroquois transmission systems IGTS existing infrastructure to transport natural gas from the US Canadian border at Waddington, New York through the existing system located in New York State and Connecticut to the existing (unintelligible) connection with our gas distribution system at (unintelligible).

When complete, this option can provide up to approximately 125,000 dekatherms per day of base load capacity. We would split this capacity with Conn Ed so we would each add 62.5 thousand dekatherms per day to our respective systems. This would enhance reliability to our system, especially to the gate delivery point serving our most eastern bound customers. Above ground weather events and manmade events such as traffic and automobile accidents would not impact availability of the natural gas supply.

This option will have a moderate impact on the environment. As construction will take place on an already existing line, the impact will be focused on locations already developed. As part of this project, Iroquois plans to further reduce methane and overall emissions at sites by installing low nitrogen oxide NOX turbine units that will reduce NOX emissions by 40% over standard turbine units.

Potential greenhouse gas emissions will also be mitigated by Iroquois' proposal to install methane recovery systems. All permitting, policy and regulatory requirements must comply with (Ferk) regulations and other appropriate federal, state and local agencies. The project filed a formal application with the Federal Energy Regulatory Commission in February 2020 and is expecting a decision on approval by early 2021. Assuming timely approvals, the project can be in service by November 2023.

Because this solution only fills part of the gap between demand and supply and is estimated to take three years to come online, it would also be paired with a series of near term and ongoing incremental energy efficacy demand response and electrification measures to reduce demand to completely close the gap. If the demand reduction measures do not predictably meet target volumes or timelines, there would have to be restrictions on new customer connections.

In addition, unless demand reduction can predictably exceed targets, we would have to retain our compressed natural gas trucking operations for periods of peak demand. The total estimated cost of this option, including both the infrastructure and the demand by programs, is 1.11 billion in our low demand scenario and 2.22 billion in our high demand scenario.

((END VIDEO))

(Bill): John, that concludes the video.

John Bruckner: Thank you, (Bill). All right. At this time, operator, we'll open up the lines to any questions on either the Clove Lakes or the Iroquois Enhancement by Compression Project. And we have (Pete Metzdorff) as our subject matter expert on the line to answer any questions. So operator?

Coordinator: Thank you. One moment. First up is - I do believe it's (Lee Ziesche). Please announce your affiliation and zip code.

(Lee Ziesche): Oh, I think that's me. (Lee Ziesche). I'm a rate payer and I am with Sane Energy Project. So you're proposing - you're saying these are all presentations that you're giving to people, but right now you're asking for $2 million to study the pipeline through Staten Island. So I'm wondering if this hasn't been presented to the public yet why you're raising our rates for that pipeline.

And then also there's no hearings on Staten Island or in the communities that would be affected by expanding the Iroquois pipeline. Do you have intentions to have hearings in those communities that would be impacted by this infrastructure?

John Bruckner: (Pete), can we address (CJ's) questions?

(Pete Metzdorff): Sure. (Lee), the question regarding the Clove Lakes line is that in order to move that project forward, we would have to do additional routing studies and what have you. So if that project is one that is selected to this whole process, then we would need to go out and fund the research in order to be able to do the background engineering that's required to route that pipeline.

With regard to the Iroquois pipeline, any hearings regarding the Iroquois Enhancement by Compression Project would go through the (FERC) process, not through National Grid. So we would not be scheduling those hearings. Those would go through the (FERC) process.

(Lee Ziesche): And will you have something on Staten Island, though, just because that is - because there's no hearings on Staten Island right now and there never was one scheduled in person.

(Pete Metzdorff): So Staten Island was never impacted by the moratorium that was put in place, so that's why there are not hearings on Staten Island at this point in time. If we were to move forward with that project, then there would be hearings at that time.

Coordinator: And up next is (John Fitzpatrick). Please state your affiliation and zip code.

(John Fitzpatrick): Hi. My name is (John), zip code 11211. I'm a rate payer. In the beginning - in the first half of this presentation, you mentioned the LNG part, you mentioned something about greenhouse gas emissions being similar to - projected greenhouse gas emissions being similar to the current infrastructure.

To those specific questions, I would appreciate an actual answer to this question. There's a - New York State has recently passed a climate law, the (CLC), the (CLCOA), CLCPA mandating a transition to 100% of renewable energy by 2050.

I'm 23 years old and I want a future for my children that I might have (unintelligible) for my community and my family. Will this project answer the question -- do not evade the question -- is this proposed project, is that

actually - do you have any idea if that's actually going to meet that requirement?

John Bruckner: So (Cameron) do you want to talk about or answer with respect to the recognition of CLCPA in the long-term report?

(Cameron): Yes. So with regards to the CLCPA, so, you know, this report that we've done clearly it is not do an environmental study out for 30 years on the details of every option. What we would say is that when we look at these different options, you know, we have looked at assessing the environmental impact, and I think with regards to meeting the CLCPA, there's sort of a number of different pathways that are out there that people are -- National Grid and others -- are aggressively looking at as far as how we can meet those goals.

So, you know, some of those goals include -- and there's been a number of studies on this, which we reference in the report -- you know, there are goals that include the utilization of natural gas as part of the solution. There are, you know, studies that look at the cost and the pathways to get there. And a number of those look at a combination of electrification as well as, you know, utilization of the gas network as a cost-effective means of achieving those goals.

So I think it's - you know, there's a number of different pathways that people look at to get to the CLCPA goal. And, you know, we think that there are opportunities to do things within the gas network. We talk about, for instance, renewable natural gas, hydrogen, you know, other things that can help drive lower emissions.

So that's really kind of the - you know, the way that we look at some of these different options and how we'd have to consider the pathways to achieving those goals.

John Bruckner: And again, (John), you certainly will have the opportunity to submit a comment and any other concerns that you may have later on at the time in this meeting and also you can submit them in writing as well on the Web site. And we'll review the Web site address again later in the meeting. Operator, I need the next question.

(Bill): We're ready for the next video, John.

John Bruckner: Okay. Thank you.

((VIDEO))

Woman 3: Incremental energy efficacy is one of our non-infrastructure long-term options. It would involve building upon and expanding the base and incremental new efficacy New York programs with a more aggressive program offering that reduces annual energy consumption and design day demand.

It will focus on gas efficiency savings with a key focus on intensive weatherization measures and will require extensive customer and trade ally engagements and training. This option (unintelligible) could potentially provide 111,000 to 216,000 dekatherms of design day savings. When implemented, this option will lead to passive energy and design day savings. It's key, however, that we're able to ramp up quickly and start realizing impacts by winter of 2021/22.

There is no additional environmental impact as work will only be completed on existing structures. Overall, this would result in a reduction of greenhouse gas emissions through less natural gas consumption. To be successful we'll need to further develop a wide range of contractors and suppliers. We will need to hire additional employees to support the spending over the duration of the program. These investments will go directly into the down state economy and any bill savings will go directly to customers.

This option will require a significant increase in level of efforts across the entire energy efficacy network including growth in number of contractors, staff in local permitting offices and increases in company employees. The program would have to scale up by 2025 to become similar in size to our current successful program in Massachusetts.

This solution requires a series of incremental energy efficacy demand response and electrification measures that start to have predictable impacts on peak demand by the winter of 2021/22 and continue to grow their impact at a size and pace that enables existing National Grid gas supply to meet customer needs. If the demand reduction measures do not predictably meet target volumes or timelines, there would have to be restrictions on new customer connections.

In addition, unless demand reduction can predictably exceed targets, we would have to retain our compressed natural gas trucking operations for periods of peak demand. The total estimates cost for this option is $1.51 billion in our low demand scenario and $2.62 billion in our high demand scenario.

This includes the total cost for the entire no infrastructure portfolio of energy

efficiency, demand response and electrification required to close the gap between supply and demand.

Man 1: Demand response is one of our non-infrastructure long-term options. Compared to other non-infrastructure options, demand response is more cost (unintelligible) effective, and can be ramped up more quickly (unintelligible). That's because demand response will leverage existing equipment at customer premises.

The overall challenge with (unintelligible) option is related to the overall number of (unintelligible) customers we have and the (unintelligible) challenges that multi-family and commercial customers have in maintaining a backup source of heat, typically fuel oil for use in temperature control or non-firm programs.

Those who fall under the temperature control category, include those multi-family and some commercial and industrial customers who we ask to switch off of natural gas and move to another fuel source, typically fuel oil when the temperature drops below a certain level, for example 16 degrees Fahrenheit.

We also have thermostat set back programs where we provide an incentive for residential customers to turn down their thermostats during cold weather events.

Implementing this option would require new rate design programs that encourage these customers to remain on non-firm rate programs. If implemented, we estimate approximately 81 to 108,000 Dekatherms of designed A savings.

One of the risks with this option is that there is no guarantee that customers

will switch to their alternate fuel, as they can still use natural gas. Accordingly, the number of participants during an event can fluctuate, and not meet projections, thereby putting reliability at risk.

We feel, however, this could improve over time as the demand response program matures. There is little or no incremental impact to the environment with this option.

In addition, there will be a limited impact to the climate, and demand response will reduce energy use during peak periods, but some of this displaced energy will swing to non-peak periods.

Meanwhile, non-firm customers switching to an alternate fuel, typically fuel oil, will result in higher greenhouse gas emissions. In the future, fuel oil could be transitioned to renewable fuels such as biofuels, which would help reduce environmental impact.

This option requires (unintelligible) Public Service Commission approval, including incentives and total investments before the program can begin, and it will impact permitting, policy and regulatory activities at the local and State level.

This solution requires a series of incremental energy efficiency, demand response, and electrification measures that start to have predictable impact on peak demand by the winter of 2021, ’22, and continue to grow their impact at a size and pace that enables existing National Grid gas supply to meet customer needs.

If the demand reduction measures do not predictably meet targets on use or timelines, there would have to be restrictions on new customer connections. In

addition, unless demand reduction can predictably exceed targets, we would have to retain our compressed natural gas trucking operations for periods of peak demand.

The total estimates cost for this option is 1.51 billion in our low demand scenario, and 2.62 billion in our high demand scenario. This includes the total cost for the entire no infrastructure portfolio of energy efficiency, demand response, and electrification required to close the gap between supply and demand.

((END VIDEO))

Man 2: John, that concludes our video.

John: All right. Very well. Again, Star 1 to ask any questions. We have Keith Sperling and Owen Brady on as our subject matter experts to answer any questions with respect to energy efficiency, demand response. So, Operator, I'd ask that you open up the lines for any questions.

Coordinator: That comes from Kayla Weisdorf, and please state your affiliation and zip code.

Kayla Weisdorf: Hi. My name is Kayla. Affiliation is Sunrise NYC. My zip code is 11222. I have two questions. One is related to the previous auctions. I was in queue but I think I was on mute. So - and then the second one is in relation to what was just presented to us.

So my first question is, why would National - oh, I'm also a ratepayer. I'm a National Grid customer. Why would National Grid pursue a waiver for any

project for New York State laws that were fought for by New Yorkers and passed by their representatives to protect us?

Doesn't make any sense to me, but I'm wondering why you would present this as an option, when the laws are in place specifically so that these kinds of projects cannot go ahead.

And then my second question is about the assumption of fuel as the only potential heat source. Why in these scenarios are combustible substances the only assumed source of heat for National Grid customers?

John: Keith or Owen, you want to take that second question?

Owen Brady: Yes, John, this is Owen. Happy to respond to the question about alternate fuel sources and what went into our assumptions. The customer segments that we are looking at, which is our temperature-controlled customer population, to date has used fuel oil as the backup in all cases.

And so the assumption here is that that would be the continued behavior. However, we're working with all of the customers to try to figure out what alternatives might exist, including their participation in the electrification efforts that would be outlined in the next option.

John: And again, Kayla, just to go back to you, I think your original question was, again we're presenting the options that are out there and giving the public an opportunity to comment on them.

So we certainly respect your opinion about that, which I think came across clear. And, Operator, I'd ask if we have any other questions.

Coordinator: That is from Emily Martin, and please state your affiliation and zip code.

Emily Martin: Hi. Can you hear me?

John: Yes, Emily, we can.

Emily Martin: Hi. I am a Rockaway resident, a ratepayer. My zip code is 11694. I've been waiting in the queue for each video, and I think one thing you touched on in each, and I will quote.

This is pulled directly from your videos, so I'm hoping you will answer. "Community impacts will be minimal." And then another caller had called in and had asked questions about the research that had gone into danger to marine life, and I believe the answer to that was, it would need to be assessed.

So my question is, what research was used when you put in your video, community impacts will be minimal?

John: Thank you. Cameron, do you want to …

Emily Martin: I'd like you to recite specific research please.

John: So Cameron, you want to address the assessment of community impacts and the various options in the study?

Cameron: Sure. So, you know, certainly when we talk about community impact, we would not say that it's uniform across every option. That was not - so your quote of, community impact would be minimal, may refer to certain options.

So our - how we're viewing the community impact is, you know, sort of that

that kind of direct impact there. so for something like, I believe it was in reference to the NeSI project, and because that is one where the infrastructure is being put in place in the water, it doesn't have a real sort of impact in that construction phase to the communities that it's serving.

John: Operator, is there another question in the queue?

Man 2: Thank you, John.

John: Or you want to go to the next …

Man 2: We should go right to next video. Next video please.

John: Okay.

((VIDEO))

Woman 2: Electrification is one of the long-term non-infrastructure options. This option presents us with an opportunity to reduce design day natural gas consumption by converting customers' space heating energy source from natural gas to electricity.

We could achieve this by using cold climate heat pumps, which operate efficiently even at cold temperatures, and they can be installed and operated without a fossil fuel backup heating system.

If we assume a robust incentive program is in place and effective, incremental electrification can yield a range of 52 to 86,000 dekatherms per day in design day demand reduction.

To achieve these reduction levels, we estimate we'll need 5,000 to 15,000 incremental customers per year, starting in 2021 to move to electric heat, cooking and industrial use.

Once implemented, this is a reliable option to reduce forecasted design day demand. It's important to know that if customers retain gas for other uses, however, such as for cooking, water heating, or as a backup heating source, the designed day savings will be less than anticipated.

There is minimal current environmental impact with this option. However, the reduction of gas consumption will be largely offset by an increased electricity consumption, with some studies showing higher current emissions for electric power than natural gas in the short term.

Longer term, due to the forecasted decarbonization of New York's electric supply, incremental electrification will result in decreased emissions. For electrification to really take hold, we'll need to create an ecosystem that will include a wide range of contractors and suppliers who will need to hire additional employees to support the spending over duration of program, and it will mean growth in total electric customers and electric demand, requiring permitting, policy and regulatory requirements to be in place, equating to significant startup costs and resources.

The biggest challenge with electrification right now is both the upfront and ongoing cost. The current cost of installation is often twice as high as the typical natural gas heating unit.

In addition, electric prices are relatively high in downstate New York, and would likely lead to overall increase in customers' annual energy utility bill.

For this option to be economic in this region, we'd have to see big increases in heat firm efficiency, or big reductions in electric prices.

Electrification requires a series of incremental energy efficiency, demand response and electrification measures that start to have predictable impact on peak demand by the winter of 2021, ’22, and continue to grow their impact at a size and pace that enables existing National Grid’s natural gas supply, to meet customer needs.

Note, if the demand reduction measures do not predictably meet target volumes or timelines, there would have to be restrictions on new customer connections.

In addition, unless demand reduction can predictably exceed targets, we would have to retain our compressed natural gas trucking operations for periods of peak demand.

The total estimates cost for this option is 1.51 billion in our low demand scenario, and 2.62 billion in our high demand scenario. This includes the total cost for the entire no infrastructure portfolio of energy efficiency, demand response, and electrification required to close the gap between supply and demand.

((END VIDEO))

Man 2: John, that concludes our last video.

John: All right. Thank you. So at this time, I really want to get to the public comment period, and give you all an opportunity to voice your concerns or comments.

But in a spirit of transparency again, we just showed another option. I do want to open it up to any callers, Operator, have a question with respect to electrification.

Again, I would ask you to keep your questions to the electrification option, anything that was unclear. And then subsequent to that, we can get on to the public comment period. So, Operator, open up the call for any questions on the electrification.

Coordinator: Our first question comes from (Eva). Please state your affiliation and zip code.

Eva: Hi. I believe that's me. My name is Eva, and I'm from 350 Brooklyn. Am I on the line? Can you hear me?

John: Yes, Eva. I can hear you loud and clear.

Eva: Oh, okay. So I just want to state, before I ask my question about electrification. I've had a question for every one of the - that you've shown, and I've not been able to ask any questions regarding that, and I've been bumped off twice, and I've had to get back on.

So regarding the electrification, I am a customer that happily has a heat pump and an electrified water heater. And I acknowledge that it costs more to install them.

But with that stated, I want to clarify something. As a customer who used to be a National Grid customer, that my heating bill has gone down. So I'd like for the record that that is not a true statement from this person who has switched off of natural gas.

John: Well, Eva, thank you for sharing that, and we did record it. So your statement there will be recorded and included in the record as well. Did you have another question about the electrification option? If not, we will then, Operator, go to the public comment period. So, Eva, did you have another question?

Coordinator: There are no other questions.

John: All right, very good. so at this time, again, we've concluded the review of the options, and at this point, we want to begin the public oral comment period, allowing you to present a public statement on any of the options, or any other public statement that you'd like to make with respect to this issue.

During such time, we do have a listening panel, including myself, Cameron, who you've heard from on the call a number of times. Cameron is the executive who prepared the report.

And we also are joined by Melanie Littlejohn. Melanie is an executive in our New York State Customer and Community Management Organization. I will remind you that this is a listening panel. So your questions will be recorded, if they're questions.

If they're statements, again, they will be recorded and put into the record, but we will not be using this time to answer any questions. It's really for you to have a public comment.

The other thing is, if you do have a public comment that you want to enter into the record on any of the options or any of - any opinion that you may want to share, I believe dial Star 1.

Again, you'll give your - you'll answer the same questions from the operator that we've done each time, and you'll be given two minutes to go through your public comment.

So again, there won't be any questions asked that will be answered, but you can certainly pose a question during your two-minute period. And again, each comment will be recorded, transcribed and submitted unabridged to the New York State Public Service Commission.

If you think that you need more time, or want to expand on your statement, you certainly will be given that opportunity. You can visit the website at NGrid.com/longtermsolutions, and upload any written statement or question directly to the New York State Public Service Commission.

Again, I remind you to hit Star 1, and we'll begin now, Operator. And again, we will have a time of two minutes for each of your public statements. So, Operator, if we can open up the lines and begin the public statement period of the call. Thank you.

Coordinator: Thank you. First up is Nick (unintelligible), and please state your affiliation and zip code.

Nick: Hi. Can you hear me?

John: Yes, we can.

Nick: Hi. Oh, great. My name of Nick (unintelligible). I work in construction. And, you know, I just want to say that this is not the time to be investing in new

fossil fuel infrastructure. These are long term investments we're making, and we need to rapidly expand the electrification process right now. Thank you.

John: Thank you, Nick. Operator, we'll go to the next statement. Operator, can we go to the next public statement?

Coordinator: That comes from Lee Ziesche. Please take your affiliation and zip code.

Lee Ziesche: Hi. Yes. My name is Lee Ziesche. I'm a ratepayer and the Community Engagement Coordinator for Sane Energy Project. My zip code is 11216. First of all, I think this is ridiculous that this whole proceeding wasn't delayed. There's a lot of people that can't participate in this because of the virtual nature, and the health crisis going on.

Second, it's very clear that most of these proposals go against the CLCPA, and National Grid is ignoring climate science and not looking at the impacts of the frack gas that is coming from Pennsylvania.

And you're saying you're listening to us, but there have been tens of thousands of comments already submitted against Williams Pipeline. So it's very clear that you're ignoring what New Yorkers have already said, and the laws they fought so very hard to get passed.

And additionally, even though it's not a part of your long-term plan, you know, right now National Grid is ignoring the north Brooklyn community, which has not consented to your MRI pipeline, and is very concerned about your workers right now in their community coming in and out.

So I think if you're really going to listen to us and the public, you need to look at the record that has already been built against the Williams Pipeline, against

LNG as people brought up, New Yorkers fought very hard to stop Port Ambrose.

And so presenting these options in a time of climate crisis, just shows that you're not actually really listening to what New Yorkers have been saying. You should also look at the thousands of comments that have already been submitted against the MRI pipeline, and the vast opposition that New Yorkers have to frack gas.

We fought very hard to fight fracking here in New York. And it's obscene that you're the frack people in Pennsylvania so that your shareholders can get money. I'm also really curious how much all these options will cost …

Man 2: 10 seconds. Please start to wrap please.

Lee Ziesche: Yes, I am. I'm wrapping right now. I see the timeline. I'm curious how much this will all cost if we just had public power and we weren't paying your shareholders for all these (unintelligible).

John: Thank you, Lee.

Coordinator: Next is Jeanette. I'm sorry, sir. Go ahead.

John: No. I was just thanking Lee for her comment. You can go to the next call, Operator.

Coordinator: Thank you. That is from Jeanette Garramone. Please state your affiliation and zip code.

Jeanette Garramone: Hi. My name is Jeanette Garramone. I'm a Rockaway resident, a ratepayer, and I'm also part of the Good Government Regular Democratic Club. My question, or my comment I should say, is basically, according to all of the 10 options that you proposed, all of them, except for maybe the last two, have some sort of an effect on water and air quality.

And in digging up in the waters, the toxins that would be released, would actually have a huge effect on our marine life. I know you said that there would have to be environmental studies in order to really know the full effect, but in the report it was stated from the member of your team, that they were impacting the ground and not necessarily the water and the environment.

And in thinking of that Rockaway, the water is our backyard. The beach is our backyard. We are a beach community, and any effect on our beach, on our parks, on our waters, on our boardwalk, anything that we would be breathing in, would be totally affecting our environment.

John: Okay. Thank you, Jeanette. Operator, can we go to the next call?

Coordinator: And you are ready for the next one?

John: Yes, Operator. Thank You.

Coordinator: Thank you. That comes from Jackie Weisberg. Please state your affiliation and zip code.

Jackie Weisberg: Hi. My name is Jackie Weisberg. My zip code is 11201, and I'm at 350 Brooklyn. So the reason we're even having these meetings is because National Grid cheated its customers out of essential gas, and is listing a trumped-up

moratorium, and not because National Grid wants to be open, caring and helpful. That's why we're having meetings.

And anyway, you shouldn't even be having these meetings during this time of crisis. They should have been postponed until we can cope with doing this, because virtually doing it is not - doesn't work for a lot of people.

And also, I think that the owners have shown that they only care about the CEOs and the bottom line. They're having the meetings because they behaved disgracefully, and they were ordered to do so, and not because they wanted to be helpful.

And in case we've forgotten, and I haven't, the Williams pipeline, which is opposed by the majority of our elected officials and our citizens, is a horrible idea and needs to be denied once and for all.

Let us remember, construction of this pipeline will churn up toxins such as mercury, arsenic, lead and PCBs, threatening the marine life that's finally coming back and oh yes, the beachgoers as well, as this woman just said, our people, our citizens.

The Williams Company has the most horrific safety record, with people killed, towns evacuated, explosions, leaks. I could go on and on. and lastly, not really lastly, everything about this goes against our new climate law, the CLCPA, that mandates we get off of fossil fuels, not to build them.

Oh, and we're supposed to pay for this. It's positively Kafkaesque. Every single frack gas proposal must be turned down, including all offshore liquid natural gas, onshore LNG, compressed natural gas offshore, and the North Brooklyn pipeline, and the Staten Island pipeline.

John: Thank you, Jackie. Operator, can we go to the next call please?

Coordinator: Steve Kessler, please state your affiliation and zip code.

Steve Kessler: Yes. Hi. Steve Kessler. I'm a member of Extinction Rebellion and Sane Energy, and I'm a ratepayer here in Greenpoint Brooklyn, zip code 11222. Yes. the eight proposals that involve mining, fracking, storage of natural gas, is a nonstarter as far as I'm concerned in terms of - you know, it's just - with the climate legislation on the books, with the climate crisis, it's just abhorrent that those proposals was on the table.

I feel like, you know, eight and 10 are more like green deal type of projects, and potentially going all in on them and creating new jobs, the right kind of jobs in that regard, yes it's just incredible that part 8, non-fossil fuel related proposals.

Also, the MRI North Brooklyn transmission line project, got to shut that down with endangering workers and residents in the midst of this pandemic. And also, you know, just having a fossil fuel project enhanced in our neighborhood, is also deeply offensive.

It's just got to go all in on, you know, carbon zero technologies, just amazing, all these years that we're not there yet. And that is all. Thank you.

John: Thank you, Steve. Operator, next caller please.

Coordinator: Assembly District Leader, Lew Simon. Please state your affiliation.

Lew Simon: Good evening. My name is Lew Simon. I'm the Assembly District Leader in the 23rd Assembly District, a resident of Rockaway, 11694. I'm extremely angry and mortified during a major crisis and pandemic, National Grid would think about themselves and attempt to get away with hijacking us again with this public hearing via the phone, which is totally unacceptable.

Many people did not get this notice, including myself, to 2 o'clock this afternoon. National Grid was already caught with their pants down by the governor. He had to sign by executive order, demanding for you to give people who were hurt during Hurricane Sandy, their homes were destroyed, they were rebuilding, and you guys refused to give them the gas.

They had to sue to get the gas back and new customers. It's quite obvious that you have enough reserves that once the order was written, you were able to do so. I don't know why you're not looking to alternatives. Alternatives are the answer.

The dubious programs that want to do to destroy the environment, to destroy the Rockaway, will put us in jeopardy. During Hurricane Sandy, they snuck the Williams pipeline in, but we're smart and we're wise, and we're not going to let National Grid get away with this.

Urging everyone to stay on these calls and get your comments in. say no to national plan. Thank you.

John: Thank you, Lew. Operator, can we go to the next caller please?

Coordinator: That is Wendy Fried. Your line is open, and please state your affiliation and zip code.

Wendy Fried: Yes. This is Wendy Fried with 350 Brooklyn. My zip code is 11217. So I just want to echo that basically a lot of things have been said, which is first of all, it really is an outrage that this is happening now tonight in the middle of this crisis.

Not only did people not get notice, not only can - people not participate virtually, but this is a time when our attention is totally hijacked by other things, and the idea that you can have a meaningful public hearing right now, is just absurd.

I for one have not - this is the first time I've seen these LNG proposals and all these other things, which we don't have time to prepare. So I can't comment on those. I will comment on the (NESE), which is where I have some familiarity with.

And as others have said here, there are a number of problems here. We don't need the gas. The need is trumped up in a circular process to make it where you contract for it, and then all of a sudden, we need it.

It conflicts with the CLCPA. We're never going to reach our climate goals if we keep rebuilding pipelines. There are all the water quality issues that have been mentioned, and of course the cost, money that could be going into renewable infrastructure.

I had a question about the (NESE) that I wasn't able to - I wasn't allowed to ask earlier. So I want to say, there's a 15-year contract for the gas that National Grid has the exclusive contract for. Let's say that you all managed to somehow get this thing done and in 2021 you build it. 15 years is 2036.

So what I would like to know is, what year between now and 2036, will we stop using gas? Thank you.

John: Thank you, Wendy. And Operator, can we go to the next caller please.

Coordinator: Up next is Eva. Please state your affiliation and your zip code.

Eva: My name is Eva, and I'm from 350 Brooklyn. And I am also very upset by having this meeting online. I have been bumped off three times. I've had questions for every single option that you've had and I was only allowed to say one or two sentences about heat pumps.

So I would like to know about you so-called partnership with Con Edison and I would like to know where Con Edison would be getting their energy from and I would like to make sure that Con Edison, if you are to partner with them, that they're not getting their energy from your fracked gas. And I would like also acknowledgement of the environment and the environmental impact and I agree wholeheartedly with all of the statements about a pipeline being laid underneath the water.

It does affect the community, there is an environmental impact and we have the Clean Water Act that is a law and we New Yorkers have worked really hard to try to clean our water up and to have species survive during this climate crisis and any pipeline in the water would affect that.

And I would also like more studies about the effects of fracked gas on our air quality. Many fracked gas has radon in it and radon is the number two cause of lung cancer and you talk about an option for a pipeline in a densely populated area, with a city that has people who do not have higher incomes

and have children who have asthma and it's a pretty proven fact that natural gas contributes to asthma.

So National Grid should change your corporate model. Change it, change it now. Start building an infrastructure that is renewable and stop harming us, the people here. And regarding the heat pumps, give incentives so that people can install them instead of charging people greater rates for your pipes. We would pay for that infrastructure that we don't even want.

Man: Thank you, (Eva). Operator, can we go to the next call please?

Coordinator: That is from (Alex Dillon) and please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Alex Dillon): My name is (Alex Dillon), affiliated with the Long Island Progressive Coalition, zip code 11516 and I want to state it's essential that we keep in mind the legal environment in which this entire discussion is taking place. The Climate Leadership and Community Protection Act mandates getting to zero emissions by 2050, which includes going down to 15% pf 1990's levels by 2050 and 60% of 1990's levels by 2030.

That's ten years from now. That's practically tomorrow we're talking about. That means that if new pipeline infrastructure is built, the gas in that pipeline will be illegal in 30 years. It is unsustainable, reckless and foolish to build a new pipeline considering the CLCPA law which New York State must abide by and has committed to.

The sustainable non-infrastructure solutions are not only desirable, they are the only feasible solutions. Moreover, they promise, they call for an ecosystem of new jobs, licensed contractors, vendors and I'm taking this

language from National Grid's own publicity on the matter and company employees.

And this is exactly the kind of thing that climate activists are hoping for, green jobs and should National Grid choose to go with the sustainable options, I can tell you that activists like myself will support you and back you 100% because this is exactly what we're asking for.

Thank you for holding this meeting and by showing that these issues are still important, even in the midst of a crisis. Thank you so much.

Man: (Alex), thank you for your comment. Operator, next caller please?

Coordinator: (Kevin LaCherra), please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Kevin LaCherra): Hi, can you hear me?

Man: Yes, I'm sorry, I didn't get your name, though.

(Kevin LaCherra): Sure, it's (Kevin LaCherra) (unintelligible)

Man: Oh, thanks. Okay, very well, (Kevin).

(Kevin LaCherra): My zip code is 11222, I'm in Green Point, work with Sane Energy as well as the entire coalition here in North Brooklyn that is opposing the Reliability Project, the pipeline that is coming through our community right now and I'm pretty deeply concerned, you know, I mean, I have been – I'm a Type 1 diabetic.

So I'm one of those immune compromised people they've been talking about. I've been in my house for 11 days, sheltering in place like probably so many of the people that are on this call and every day, I see pictures and video of workers not social distancing, working around the clock on the North Brooklyn pipeline.

You know, National Grid, Mr. (Rose) had come to our community board and said they were going to do what was best for the community and you know, we didn't – we didn't believe them at that point, right? And we certainly don't believe them now. It's become just abundantly clear. Those workers are not social distancing, they're working around the clock to put in this pipeline. Everything else has come to a complete standstill and in all honesty, they're going to get people killed.

You are responsible for putting this community in so much more danger than the long term or short-term consequences of the pipeline. You're going to put those workers in danger, you're going to put this community in danger as they're coming to work every day on busses, in trains and then coming through this community of folks of, you know, elderly and lower income folks and you know, just the people that live here.

This has been a very difficult process to, you know, even get on to this call. It's been inaccessible. Every elected representative is with us on this, the public advocate just said that that pipeline is not necessary infrastructure and should be abiding by the moratorium on construction. We're in the midst of a global pandemic and it just seems like National Grid is concerned about, you know, squeezing every penny out of this that they can.

You know, I know you're not going to respond to this but you know, the actions that your company is taking are going to get people in this community and in the city killed.

Man: Thank you, (Kevin). Operator, can we get the next caller, please?

Coordinator: That comes from (Miles McManus). Please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Miles McManus): I'm a New York City residence – my – resident and my zip code is 10010. We're here tonight because our energy system is broken. National Grid, you're supposed to be serving your customers who are the citizens of New York but your proposal is based on short term profits, not the public welfare. All of the new natural gas infrastructure options are unacceptable. We're looking at a multibillion-dollar boondoggle here, based on disproven and self-serving assumptions.

We don't want natural gas, we don't need natural gas – natural gas, even considering new natural gas projects, the tragic waste of resources. They're never going to pass the required CLCPA evaluations. The economics of the investment are a disaster, considered on an appropriate (timeframe) and worst, the investment in fracked gas as a so-called bridge fuel will cost us critical time and taxpayer dollars that should be – that we should be using to transition to alternative renewable energy.

New York State passed the CLCPA and Cuomo added the L for leadership. We need that leadership now if our kids are going to have a future. The IPCC and the CLCPA warn that we have to cut emissions by at least 40% by 2030. We don't have time to waste. National Grid and New York State, listen to the people. Kill any further consideration of new natural gas infrastructure immediately. Make a new plan based on aggressive moves to climate-friendly,

renewable energy instead and if National Grid can't or won't act in the public interest, then shut them down, replace them with a public utility who will. Thank you.

Man: Thank you, (Miles). Operator, the next caller, please?

Coordinator: That is (Claire Whitcomb). Your line is open and please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Claire Whitcomb): Hi. I – my name is (Claire Whitcomb) I live in – on the Madison Environmental Commission in Madison, New Jersey, 07940. I'm wondering about the comment that was in all these videos that we need to ramp up quickly for natural gas and I'm wondering why that is key, because it's clear that some of these other options, like conservation and electrification will work, they will just take longer and we will need to use the solution of trucking more gas or other things if peak demand occurs but as people have pointed out, the temperature is fluctuating, we can't really – we don't have reliable models any more on what our winters will be like and I'm questioning whether we need a permanent infrastructure for what is clearly a temporary need.

I also would like clarification on where the gas, particularly from the Williams pipeline actually ends up, whether it services New York and New Jersey, which are impacted by the construction and would be impacted by any leaks or whether it is exported or going to other states. Thank you. Those are my concerns.

Man: Thank you, (Claire). Operator, can we get the next call please?

Coordinator: Up next it (Alex Beacham), please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Alex Beauchamp): Hi, I'm (Alex Beauchamp), I'm the North East Region Director at Food and Water Action. I'm here in Brooklyn, New York. My zip is 11217. So I'll start by saying, as so many others have, it's grossly irresponsible for National Grid to keep these public meetings on the schedule in the midst of the giant pandemic. We shouldn't be having this at all but if we're going to have it, the process by which you created this bizarre video conference where you can't actually see anybody is truly weird.

And you know, I've thought a lot about this recently because as so many other folks on the call, I'm sure, and around the country, many of us are working from home, many of us are going to meetings that used to be in person that are now virtual. This is by far the worst of them that I've been in. It's absolutely crazy.

And I'll say one other thing about the process, it's crazy that we don't have the call-in information for tomorrow's call or for the next call on Wednesday. It's possible to give it in advance. For instance, I'm on several calls this Friday for work. I know the call-in info. I'm on a bunch of calls next week, I know the call-in info for. There's several calls next month I know the call-in info for so I could go on and on, but I will not.

What I'll say here is that we're turning the world upside down as part of this pandemic, right? I'm working from home with a toddler, all day long, and it's crazy and I'm aware that I'm one of the lucky ones, right? There's so many people much, much worse off than me but we're doing that, right, societally, because we see a giant threat. Climate change is the same thing. We have to turn our thinking upside down, we cannot continue with business as normal and particularly cannot, right? We have to completely change the business model, as other folks have said.

So the fact that you've come here, presented eight options of just moving more fracked gas around, again, it's grossly irresponsible but it also just shows National Grid is not ready to move us where we need to go and I'm inclined to agree with our city's comptroller, (Scott Stringer), it's time to start thinking about a public takeover. We need public power now.

Man: Thank you, (Alex) and Operator, can we get the next caller, please?

Coordinator: That is (Neil Ross). Please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Neil Ross): I'm president of NH Ross Incorporated, my zip code is 11953, I am out in (Suffolk County), Long Island and I just wanted to state that I disagree with everybody on this forum tonight. I run a plumbing, heating and air conditioning business.

I've been converting people from oil heat to gas heat for many years, since (unintelligible) days and natural gas burns so much cleaner than oil and for all you people out there that are talking about pollution and the environment, natural gas is the way to go at this point.

Heat pumps, yes, they're great, but if you don't have the infrastructure in place to run them and don't forget, they run on electricity. How do you think these plants on Long Island are making electric? It's mainly coming from natural gas or oil, which is very polluting to the environment.

So I just wanted to make that statement. I employ quite a few people that they make their living converting people from oil to gas heat and I think sometimes people just see one side of the picture and they don't see the whole big picture

of everything going on out there and I'm sure that everybody is disagreeing with me tonight but that's okay and that's my statement for tonight.

Man: Okay, thank you, (Neil) and Operator, could we go to the next speaker please?

Coordinator: Yes, the next is from (unintelligible). Please state your affiliation and zip code.

Man: I'm sorry, I didn't get the name.

Coordinator: Caller, can you please state your name?

(Samir): Hello?

Coordinator: Yes, go ahead. Please state your name, your affiliation and zip code.

(Samir): Oh, I'm sorry. My name is – my name is (Samir), I'm a New York City resident, my zip code is 11372 and I'd like to make a comment that I support the (unintelligible) pipeline. Apparently, (unintelligible) is a system that imports foreign natural gas from Canada which obviously would make it more expensive than gas that's produced right here in America. I don't doubt for a second that any customers would have to foot that bill to us at the cost of foreign energy. It doesn't make sense for any business to do that.

To me, this option does not make sense. We should not expanding our reliance on foreign energy, we should be looking at pipeline solutions that bring in domestic gas, such as the (unintelligible) pipeline. I agree with New York's goals on renewable energy but I also understand that there is a need for gas right now. Thank you.

Man: Okay, thank you, (Samir). Operator, could we go to the next call, please?

Coordinator: Up is (Lynn Tondrick). Please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Lynn Tondrick): Hi, can you hear me?

Man: Yes, (Lynn), we can. Thank you.

(Lynn Tondrick): Great. My affiliation, I'm with 350 Brooklyn. I'm also a natural gas user at my home, hopefully working my way off of it. Two things. One, we're obviously in the middle of an incredible pandemic here in New York City. We are the epicenter, literally and so having this meeting during this crisis seems really insane to me.

Number two, my neighbors and I have solar and my neighbors actually also have heat pumps and they've got the (unintelligible) and they now have no natural gas for heat. That's my goal. I'm working towards it but it really seems like a great solution to me.

Number three, I'm really concerned about the dredging and the effect on marine wildlife. I think it's really just tragic that they're not here to have a voice for themselves and that you know, we just keep destroying our environment and destroying their home. So I am absolutely against it on multiple fronts, thank you for listening.

Man: Thank you for your comment, (Lynn). Operator? Next caller?

Coordinator: Up next is (Kim Fraczek). Please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Kim Fraczek): Hi, (Kim Fraczek). I'm with Sane Energy Projects and my zip code is 11206. I'm going to read a couple of talking points from a coalition that I work with called Renewable Heat Now, specifically about moving us off gas and moving us on to a renewable economy for heat.

So of the eight options considered by National Grid, seven are fossil fuel projects that would be built by the gas and utility customer money. New York's climate law requires a 40% reduction of greenhouse gases by 2030 and the elimination of greenhouse gases by 2050. How could National Grid propose bringing in more methane into New York?

Number two, the report in your study shows that non-fossil fuel options can meet the growing demand for thermal energy and contribute to the phase out of fuel oil within National Grid's service area. It's possible and it must be done.

Number three, the no infrastructure option, which includes energy efficiency, demand response, electrification through heat pumps is the only legally viable option as one of the cheaper options discussed in the report. The "no infrastructure option" is $300 million cheaper than the (unintelligible) pipeline as long as National Grid meets its currently mandated energy efficiency targets. If National Grid misses those targets, then the company will need the more expensive solutions to avoid fossil fuels. National Grid should not be allowed to miss those targets.

Number four, National Grid stacked its analysis to favor gas infrastructure. The company failed to take into account the impact of methane on the 20-year timescale now required by law. It failed to quantify the other benefits the energy efficiency and heat pumps brings to households and communities.

Number five, the people of New York have spoken and the (Nessy) pipeline, already roundly rejected in response to tens of thousands of public comments. Simultaneously, a huge social movement won by the passage of the legally binding Climate Leadership and Community Projection Act. National Grid needs to get the message. It's time to stop funding methane gas and it's time to fund the solution, whether that puts you out of business or not. We are (unintelligible)…

Man 2: Can you start wrapping? Thank you.

Man: Go ahead, (Kim), finish, please.

Coordinator: Next public statement comes from (Alexandra Zevin). Your line is open.

(Alexandra Zevin): Hi, my name is (Alexandra Zevin). I'm a rate payer, a third generation New Yorker and a Brooklyn home owner. My zip code is 11238. I am outraged that this pathetic excuse for a public meeting is being paid for by rate payer money. It is inappropriate to treat the public this way and to treat rate payers this way when we are paying the salaries of folks at National – you know, I just – so there's that.

I'd like to say that the (MRI) pipeline and the Williams pipeline and the other infrastructures that are being suggested go against New York State climate law and they are not in keeping with the United Nations Inter-Governmental Panel on Climate Change and – or its Inter-Governmental Science Policy Platform on Biodiversity and Ecosystem Services.

The – how to put it – you know, the pipeline, for instance, we did all this work to prevent that disastrous pipeline from being built and now, basically, as rate payers, we are paying you all to reinstitute the pipeline and to push it again.

And I need to ask you, I mean, it's been shown that the threats to endangered species by the Williams pipeline, it would endanger the Atlantic sturgeons, the osprey, the humpbacked, the bald eagle, the North Atlantic white whale, the barred owl, the finned whale, the black crowned night heron.

All of these things – all of these animals – it's not just that they're wonderful treasures by themselves, they represent biodiversity and humanity's safety net, which is what the United Nations talked about in its most recent climate diversity document.

Man 2: Please start wrapping up.

(Alexandra Zevin): We don't want the pipeline.

Man: Thank you, (Alexandria). Operator, can we go to our next caller?

Coordinator: That is from (Tom Ross). Your line is open. Please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Tom Ross): My name is (Tom Ross). I'm affiliated with Sane Energy Project and Earth Strike New York. What I would like to – I would like to make a comment – a number of comments. One, in relationship to a number of people who talked about a big picture.

But first of all I want to say that I really support a number of the comments that have been made about the fact that National Grid are working on this the facilities in North Brooklyn and on the pipelines while all of this stuff is going on with the pandemic and the fact that this meeting is being held at the same time seems to me like a more or less cynical exploitation of public inattention.

Some of us call that disaster capitalism at its finest. I will say that I agree with the kind of typically brazen intent that that's associated with, wherever it's occurred across the country, namely, New Orleans, Katrina, we can go on the list, on and on but we won't stop there for now.

My main points are as follows. If you want to talk about the big picture, given your projections of decreasing demand, 2.4% going long term to less than 1%, the (NESE) line itself, the build out of LNG facilities and the larger economic picture that's facing your peddling, your pushing of this corrupt, environmentally destructive fuel, namely low prices in the United States caused by your own overproduction, you're burning through cash.

Foreign competition with the Russians and the Saudis, your coal project, from end to end, from soup to nuts, starting with the (NESE) and all the other facilities that you're proposing, including the LNG, smells to me like a build out of something that's going to eventually feed into either a fee to the petrol industry or exports, huge emissions, huge emissions of fossil fuel, huge environmental damage either way.

So my feeling is that you talk about demand, you talk about meeting demand but yet you state long term that the demand is going to decrease. Somebody talked about fulfilling domestic demand with domestic sources, the gas isn't going to be ultimately going to domestic sources. It's going to export.

It's going to support the price structures of the people who are fracking the gas. They have so much gas that they can't sell it now. They're building petrochemical facilities all over this country, in West Virginia, elsewhere, there's a cracker being constructed in Wyalusing or being talked about being constructed in Wyalusing, Pennsylvania right now.

So my feeling is that, as other people have said, this isn't about satisfying the demand, local demand for energy. It sabotages the Community Leadership and Climate Protection Act, sabotages our targets for emissions control and development of renewable by crowding those things out, damages water quality. You guys don't even have the studies together to actually know what the long-term impacts are of many of the options that you presented.

So I have to say that this is yet another manifestation of corporate interest usurping the public trust and the public will, prima facie. You should be ashamed of yourselves, period. That's it.

Man: Thank you, (Tom). Operator, could we go to the next call please?

Coordinator: That is from (Jay Wu) and please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Jay Wu): Hi, I'm (Jay). I'm a rate payer in Brooklyn, zip code 11225 and I'm with (NYC DSA) and I think what most people on this call are rallying against is greed over public stewardship and make no mistake, that is the reason we are facing this awful, disastrous pandemic right now. From livestock practices that cause animal diseases to evolve into human ones to austerity measures that leave hospitals unprepared for the surge in patients, today a pandemic, tomorrow the disastrous effects of climate change.

We need public power now so that decisions are made in all of our long term interests and so that surplus revenue goes into the community, into retraining so that anyone who is employed and at risk by changing to renewables, you know, those who are leading us to a sustainable future, building and hooking up renewable heat and energy and really be the heroes of our communities.

Man 1: Okay, thank you (Jay). Operator, can we go to the next call please?

Coordinator: This caller you did not record your name. Can you please state your name, affiliation and ZIP Code? Your line is open. Would you like me to move on?

((Crosstalk))

(John buckling): Yes, I'm sorry. Can you hear me now? Can you hear me?

Coordinator: Yes, go ahead. We can hear you.

(John Buckley): Okay. My name is (John Buckley). I'm a National Grid ratepayer and a New York State resident, it's 14209. And I just feel like this is an outrage to have such a poorly orchestrated an unfair platform during a national crisis. Also wanted to point out that the videos were poor quality and there was a lot that I couldn't hear. I'm hoping that they'll be available to see again.

And I think the overall thing that I wanted to say is that it's outrageously irresponsible of National Grid because there's an obvious disregard of the welfare of the people and an immoral focus on your own profit. The focus is immoral and irrational. And anyone paying attention knows that fossil fuel corporations will never change even though you're threatening the very life of the planet.

And this makes it obvious that the only real solution for energy needs is a ratepayer owned and democratically controlled energy structure and the end of private profit on our energy that we pay for. And that's my statement.

Man 1: Thank you (Brian). I'm sorry (John), (John) thank you (John). Operator, can we get the next caller please?

Coordinator: Up next is…

(Sophie): (Sophie) Patagonia.

Coordinator: Please state your affiliation and ZIP Code.

(Sophie): Hi. My name is (Sophie). I work for Patagonia ZIP Code 10024. I just want to say reiterating what people have already said that this is absurd. It was incredibly difficult to get on this call in the first place. You need to download a comb extension. You then need to also have access to a phone in addition to a computer.

But my main comment is about the Williams Pipeline. As somebody who has studied biology and medical sciences the public health risk associated with fracking alone should be enough to put an end to this pipeline. Methane causes oxygen deficiency and respiratory difficulty. New York City has already taken great strides to improve its air quality so it's completely counterproductive and reckless to disregard those efforts and put our neighbors in harm's way.

Renewable energy solutions can and must handle this job. All future energy plans should be established in line with the state's legislation and frankly that should go without saying. I mean we're at a global tipping point. Climate change is here it's happening. There is no denying it.

At a time when we should and are - we should be and are investing in renewable energy sources it is responsible and self-serving to propose a pipeline that would unnecessarily endanger the lives of New York residents

and the (ecosystems) on which all life depends. So that's all I've got to say. Thank you.

Man 1: Thank you (Sophie). Operator, can we go to the next call.

Coordinator: Yes, up next is (Greg). And please state your affiliation and ZIP Code.

(Greg Bratone): My name is (Greg Bratone) 10803. I'm part of the Extinction Rebellion and Human on Planet Earth here. First of all read the situation. We are sitting at home in isolation hundreds of New Yorkers are dying and we are at the epicenter of a global pandemic. This is ridiculous. Why are we having these meetings, postpone them?

Second, you want the people of Brooklyn to pay hundreds of millions of dollars in rate increases when thousands of peoples have lost their jobs already, and people don't know where they're going to get their next paychecks from, one of the worst economic recession since the Great Depression is on its way and yet here we are having to stand up to National Grid because you guys want to sneak this plan by the people and profit off this moment of unbelievable crisis.

I want to echo what someone else said about putting workers in danger. You are making them go out and risk contracting COVID-19. You do not care about your workers and you certainly don't care about your customers. It is unconscionable and yet will not be forgotten.

So I will echo another sentiment shame on you. I want to ask if none of your horrible solutions are approved -- and I'll put solutions in quotations because they don't solve anything except increase your profits -- will you again turn

off gas to your customers in an attempt to extort them and hold them hostage until your demands are met just like you did with the Williams Pipeline?

I just wanted to know if that was part of your plan. At this point in the climate emergency there is absolutely no reason to expand fossil fuel infrastructure and continue extracting fracked gas especially when the people of New York have clearly spoken. And want to lock us in for another ten years of unsustainable dirty energy that will contribute to the collapse of our environment and society, shame on you again.

You will not build the Williams Pipeline nor will any of these other solutions be built because they are not viable. The energy of the New York City, the New York of energy city will be taken over by the people. We have had enough of this. You should reconsider your plans. Thank you

Man 1: Thank you (Greg). Operator, can we go to the next caller please?

Coordinator: That comes from Annie Garneva. Your line is open. Please state your affiliation and ZIP Code.

Annie Garneva: Hi. My name is Annie Garneva. I'm with Sane Energy Project ZIP Code 11226 and also a ratepayer. One of the main things that I would like to point out is just beyond the process of doing this during a pandemic is the actual down to the nitty gritty details of the process.

You guys have – are just riddled with linguistic manipulation tactics throughout the entire presentations that you give. You have faulty comparison points between one option versus the other option. In certain places you name environmental risks and other places you don't certain places your name community risks others you don't.

You spent 2/3 of the presentation on energy efficiency describing the potential risks of not being able to incentivize people to switch over yet you spent approximately five seconds talking about minimal environmental risk about a pipeline that would rip apart the bottom floor for a year destroy all marine communities underneath and then bring us fossil fuels that are shown to burn to cause more omissions at 86% of rate than carbon.

So if this is so obvious and offensive the manipulation tactics that you're using that it like - you clearly either think that we are very stupid, unplanned, incapable of forming arguments it's just it's very, very frustrating to think, to realize that you think so low of us. Maybe you have gotten so used to decades of people not paying attention because your entire network of manipulation has worked so well up to this point but it's not working anymore. So please work harder for the billions of dollars that you profit off of us.

Number two, the very premise of this performance that you're having is faulty. You only have a license to operate gas networks. You do not have a license to operate other types of energy. So the very premise of presenting us with long-term options is under girthed by the fact that you can only give us options on gas.

So we know that the only way out of this is that we need energy options not gas. Your customers want energy not the gas that you're only allowed to profit from. So we know that the only way to get out of the situation is for you to stop existing. Thank you.

Man 1: Thank you Annie. Operator, can we go to the next call?

Coordinator: That is from (Mara). Your line is open. And please state your affiliation and ZIP Code.

(Mara Burns): Hi. My name is (Mara Burns) 11377. I'm a ratepayer. I also affiliated with Patagonia. I - a lot of the points that have been raised so far are really great so I don't need to reiterate those. But I do think I need to reiterate that like we're in the middle of a public health crisis and you're continuing business as usual.

And I think this is a time where we really need to be evaluating what like what we're doing and how we're operating our businesses because this is like really linked like this health crisis is linked to the environmental crisis that we're facing right now. And I just can't understand why we're continuing to push like fracking and pipelines especially when we've already oppose this over and over again.

And I'd just like it's just really shameful to be continuing business as usual right now. What we need to be doing is reevaluating everything that we're doing, how we're running our businesses, how we're getting energy to people and to just have this call it's like oh we're working from home let's just jump on a call is just ignoring everything that's happening around us. And I feel like you're not even caring about the health and safety of your customers. That's all I've got. Thank you.

Man 1: Thank you (Mara). Operator, next call please.

Coordinator: That is from (Francesca). Please state your affiliation and ZIP Code.

(Francesca): Hi. My name is (Francesca). And I'm a New York City resident. I just want to say that to me some of the options you presented don't really make sense. I'm

seeing that the best-case scenario for the Iroquois Pipeline is an in-service date of November 2023.

Please correct me if I'm wrong but that doesn't really meet the required timeframe identified by National Grid. That also doesn't consider other potential delays over the next three years. I'm tired of delays let's just get this done. We can't face the prospect of another moratorium on gas hookups in this uncertain economy right now. Thank you.

Man 1: Thank you (Francesca). Operator, next call.

Coordinator: Next is (Laura Shindell). Your line is open. And please provide your affiliation and ZIP Code.

(Laura Shindell): Hi. I'm (Laura Shindell) here from Food and Water Action. I live at ZIP Code 10019. I'd like to reiterate that these meetings should be postponed considering the pandemic we're in the middle of. It is difficult for elected officials, press not to mention residents and everyday people to join and meaningfully participate in these hearings considering the crisis that we're in. And I think it's appalling that National Grid would not take the pandemic into account.

With that said I'd also like to voice my opposition to though Williams NESE Pipeline and all of the fossil fuel projects that National Grid is proposing. We already know the Williams Pipeline would be devastating to the environment. And that's been shown by the fact that New York State and New Jersey have both rejected it. And we don't think that their new application is meaningfully different from the application that was rejected.

But furthermore compressed natural gas trucks or off shore LNG terminals are also despicable options and New Yorkers stand adamantly opposed to moving fracked gas around by any method. We're in a climate crisis. Scientists have been sounding the alarm desperately and none of your infrastructure proposals meet the requirements that scientists say we need to do as a nation and as a world to move off of fossil fuels. We need to meet the next climate crisis, the next crisis which is the climate crisis with the seriousness and action that scientists say we need.

And we're not seeing that from National Grid in any of your proposals not to mention this format is very difficult. I was on queue five times during the questioning portion of this with specific questions for each of the proposals. And I was – the operator said there were no more questions. That was a lie.

And it's been very difficult to engage people in this format which is long and you advertised the call-in info far too late. We really hope that you'll revisit this and we need Governor Cuomo and the Public Service Commission to embrace entirely renewable options no more fracked gas for New York State. Thank you.

Man 1: Thank you for your comments (Laura). Next caller operator.

Coordinator: (Yarden Orly), your line is open. Please state your affiliation and ZIP Code.

(Yarden Orly): Hi. My name is (Yarden Orly). My ZIP Code is 10012. And my affiliation is Patagonia. I'm just going to pull a couple statistics here the first one is going to be from the New York State Department of Environmental Conservation. And that is that natural and fracked gas currently between 7 cents and 10 cents per kilowatt per hour that is equivalent and even a little bit more expensive in some cases as wind.

Currently New York State gets 2.6% of its energy from wind. But according to the NYDC's Web site we have the potential to source 50% of the state's energy from wind. The US Energy and Information Administration also forecasted demand as significantly lower than National Grid forecast in their own report an adjusting case on the EIAs data would reduce National Grid's projection of future energy need by 85%. I'm just curious how - where is the trust in an organization a corporation that is off by that much with the rest of their proposal.

Third, the public has (unintelligible) these projects time and time again. This is my third time coming to one of these public hearings. All of them which are advertised extremely late and at times and locations that are extremely hard to get to for most of the people who are affected by these.

And I would just like to say that in conclusion any non-renewable energy proposal are disingenuous with regards to New York State energy sourcing and environmental goals that Governor Cuomo has specifically laid out and the people of New York have voted on and have been tremendously outspoken about. Thank you very much.

Man 1: Okay, thank you (Yarden). Operator, next caller please.

Coordinator: It comes from Madison Chamblin. Your line is open and please state your affiliation ZIP Code.

(Madison): Hello.

Man 1: Yes, go ahead (Madge).

(Madison): Hi. My name is (Madison). I'm a college student from Nassau County. My ZIP Code is 11590. And I just want to start off by saying that I'm deeply concerned about the environmental impact of all of the projects that you propose. There has only been one person on this call who has been in support of any of the proposed projects which shows that the ethos of this business does not align with the public consciousness. And there is no long-term solution that should involve fossil fuels.

It doesn't take a scientist to see that this is a problem. I'm 18. I'm a teenager and I can see that this is not legally feasible, this is not environmentally responsible and not conducive to that risk enforced by local laws and the COEP and other climate friendly legislations.

So I just think that you need to reconsider and take into account what the public wants and just try to put forth something that is what the people want and something that will be regenerative in nature and not something that is destructive and harmful to the environment. That's it. Thank you.

Man 1: (Madge), thank you. I'm sorry (Madison), thank you for your comment.

Coordinator: The next…

Man 1: Operator, next call.

Coordinator: ...it's from John Rath. Your line is open. And please state your affiliation and ZIP Code.

John Rath: My name is John Rath. I work for New York GEO. And my ZIP Code is 12601. I have read your report and I'm wondering how other countries have successfully used demand reduction, heat pumps as alternative to fossil fuels

and energy efficiency to meet their goals and yet we seem to be struggling to do that? I guess on a side note to the gentleman who his name is (Neil) and he opposed the most of the people on this call.

I guess I would like to share with him that the latest studies seemed to indicate that burning of natural gas when you look at the extraction of it, the transportation of it and the burning of it is more polluting and has more emission than either oil or propane. So that's important is point.

To me demand reduction definitely heat pumps as alternatives to fossil fuels and energy efficiency as you folks stated is the most community friendly, the healthiest, the most immediate solution, the most cost effective or one of the most cost-effective. And it eliminates the huge long-term amortization costs of putting pipes in the ground.

So folks I hope you will concentrate and heed some of the comments tonight and really focus on those three non-pipeline alternatives. And I do appreciate the opportunity for input. Thank you.

Man 1: Thank you John. Thank you for your comments. Next caller please.

Coordinator: The next caller I was not able to get a name. If you did not state a name your line is open. If you could please give your affiliation and ZIP Code? I'm not getting a response. Would you like me to move on?

Man 1: Give it another minute.

Coordinator: All right.

Man 1: Give it – caller, are you on mute maybe? All right operator I think we should go to the next caller please.

Coordinator: Thank you sir. That comes from (Ian Kinera). Your line is open. Please state your affiliation and ZIP Code.

(Ian Kinera): Hi. My name is (Ian Kinera). I am with the Citizens Climate Lobby. And my ZIP Code is 10003. I agree obviously with all of those who stated that we're in the midst of a public health crisis. But we're also in a climate crisis even though at this particular point in time the impacts aren't quite so apparent.

But scientists and even the evidence of the past few years demonstrates that the climate crisis is real, it's no longer imagined. And most of these proposals being put forward by National Grid fly in the face of climate science. They are in fact climate science, a denial of climate science in the same way as the asbestos companies, and the cigarette companies, the opioid companies in the past have tried to deny the facts.

In this case even the legislation in New York has recognized the science and has put forward some very bold targets as others have enunciated this evening. So in response to that comments about how these proposals conform with the CLCPA if I understood correctly and under the poor sound conditions the National Grid spokesman in effect said, "Well we don't look as far ahead as 2050." And I find this very hard to believe because most of these – for most of these proposals the infrastructure proposals they don't start till 2025 and 2050 isn't far away.

And the question then is who is going to bear the costs of this stranded assets? Is it the ratepayers most probably if not the shareholders? Somebody is going to bear the cost. And we shouldn't be investing right now in infrastructure,

fossil fuel infrastructure. National Grid should try and leap out of this box and if it wants to continue in the energy industry it should invest in non-fossil fuel infrastructure. Thank you. Oh I really messed that up.

Man 1: (Ian), I think we got all of your comments. Thank you so much. Operator, next caller.

Coordinator: Thanks. It comes from (Chris Marchand). Your line is open. And please state your affiliation and ZIP Code.

(Chris Marchand): Yes hi. I'm (Chris) from Manhasset, New York 11030. I don't know if I'm right calling from Nassau County. I'm not affiliated with any of these groups but I do have National Grid as my service. But listen, you know, I don't think we should be looking at any of these others citing things with natural gas onshore or barges. You know, I think it's pretty clear we need gas now.

Whatever we can get gas in the closest I, you know, I think that's the northeast project that people have talked about and as part of the presentation. But, you know, some of these other projects they're just not realistic. And we need to move forward and we need to move forward quickly because we can't go through another winter without having adequate supply. Thank you.

Man 1: Thank you (Chris). Can we get the next caller please?

Coordinator: JK Canepa your line is open. Please state your affiliation and ZIP Code.

JK Canepa: Hi, JK Canepa, C-A-N-E-P-A, Sane Energy Project. And I'm at ZIP Code 10009. Obviously the alternatives that you were proposing included nonstarters like LNG ports, and barges, and CNG trucks, and (clove) lakes

and all that sort of thing because it's clear that National Grid favors the NESE the Williams NESE Pipeline.

And after having the ratepayers pay $1 billion for this unnecessary and dangerous pipeline that would cut through Pennsylvania forests, and New Jersey towns, and place compressor stations on sinking wetlands, and give no benefit to the people of either of those states and spew fine particulate matter that was recently proven to cause childhood brain cancers.

And the sickening methane and benzene and formaldehyde in the other chemicals that come along with fracked gas. Worst of all what somebody talked about before the invisible and deadly radiation from the Marcellus Shale which is the most radioactive shale play in the United States.

And then hitting our waters and cutting six to 17 feet, trenching deep 23 miles through Staten Island oyster beds, and the benthic organisms that form our marine cycle of life and that provide the oxygen for this planet, and the menhaden food source for returning whales and all this for something that won't even be around to exist in a few decades.

And the investors are going to be struck with stranded assets. And we're going to be stuck with the stranded pipeline that we have to keep paying for and paying for four decades and gas that be salable and can't even get it out of the ground.

And all of this increased burden of carbon loaded into our atmosphere because make no mistake methane is carbon. It's carbon with four hydrogens. It's a very loaded form of carbon 86 times worse than carbon dioxide. If anybody is confused about that it's as dirty as coal according to Prof. Robert Howarth of

Cornell. And the impact of greenhouse gas emissions is 86 times worse than carbon dioxide.

And all this for what for something that's not going to be around to run gas once the CLCPA kicks in. And I'm upset that there were two National Grid workers who got burned down underneath the ground because they had to work on this unnecessary expansion of our gas infrastructure while we're trying to save this planet. And that a ConEd worker had to go to work and got the coronavirus while he was down there breathing whatever terrible stuff is underneath the ground.

And asking Trump to prop up this dying fossil fuel industry at the same time when we have to move in a direction. And I just want to say my very own Assembly person's Chief of Staff could not negotiate this arcane and clumsy process of getting a comment out to the public. And I want to know how many more people are online waiting if you can answer that question just so we have a sense of where we're - what we're going to hear for the next 25 minutes? Did you get all of that?

Man 1: Yes, we did JK.

JK Canepa: All right.

Man 1: Operator, I think we have more calls in the queue. Can we go to the next caller please?

Coordinator: (Margo Gregory), your line is open. Please state your affiliation and ZIP Code.

(Margo Gregory): Thank you very much for my name is (Margo Gregory). I am an educator with a Master's degree in Education and I'm from New York. I'm with Sane Energy Project, ZIP Code 11205. So I'm speaking to you as an educator. And what I'm hearing is that I asked two questions earlier.

I did get an answer for the first one and I'm hearing your concern about that we're in a global pandemic that you change the format of this meeting. But I do want to reiterate again that the people that this is going to most affect are not on this call and are probably unable to access this technology.

Secondly, I did not receive an answer to my second question which I asked earlier which was whether National Grid was aware of the impact on climate heating that methane gas produces. And the – and whether National Grid is aware of climate science and whether National Grid is aware of fracking and its relationship to the global climate crisis. Secondly, so I do not get an answer to that. And I did notice that.

I wanted to speak about agriculture and food safety as well as economic safety. As a citizen I try to eat locally and I try to consume locally from this region. And fracked gas is a danger to our agricultural safety, our food safety.

People who consume seafood will obviously be extremely affected by this as well as people who make their living off the seafood industry in this area.

There is a seafood – there is a local seafood industry here that will be extremely affected by it. The EPA regulates it and those are pretty good jobs. But you know what? There are endangered species that qualify for the endangered species list as endangered species here.

And I don't want to see anymore animals going extinct. I simply do not want to see anymore animals going extinct. Thank you very much for your time and attention. Have a good evening.

(John): Thank you (Margo) for your comments. Operator next question or comment please.

Coordinator: It comes from (Gail). Please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Gail): Hi my name is (Gail). I am a New York City resident. I am part of Extinction Rebellion. My zip code is 10037. And I would like to agree with all of my comrades who are opposing the – not only the North Brooklyn Pipeline but all pipelines and all fossil fuels everywhere.

We are not only a public health crisis but we are also in a climate crisis and those two issues are very, very related. And so also National Grid should not be holding these meetings amid either of these crises especially the COVID-19 crisis.

It was as I said very inaccessible for me to get onto this call. And all of the fact asked proposals to be turned down. And yes that is pretty much it. Instead of reiterating what all of my comrades have said. Instead I am going to sing you all a song which was inside the (unintelligible).

And it goes a little bit like this. The people going to rise like the water. We are going to calm this crisis down. I hear the voice of my great granddaughter saying keep it in the ground. There is too much at stake. We have justice to build and we have got bellies to fill for the sake of Mama Nature we will not sit still.

The people are going to rise like the water. We are going to shut this pipeline. I hear the voice of my great granddaughter saying keep it in the ground. The people are going to rise like the water. We are going to shut this pipeline down. I hear the voice of my great granddaughter saying keep it in the ground. Thank you.

(John): Well (Gail) thank you for your comments and certainly the manner in which you presented in. Thank you. Operator next caller please.

Coordinator: That comes from (Sade Nickels). Your line is open. Please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Sade Nickels): Hi my name is (Sade Nickels). I am a rate payer and my zip code is 11215. Can you hear me?

(John): Yes madam I can. I just didn't get the name. Can I get the name one more time madam?

(Sade Nickels): Of course. My name is (Sade Nickels). I am an educator. And as an educator who has to teach biology it is always disheartening to talk about the lack of care for biodiversity which this company has shown time and time again.

And I also am fighting and advocating for my students' futures not just to have a clean and livable planet but also to have access to jobs. And none of the options that you presented is thinking about what is happening in this moment.

The public health crisis and the climate crisis. And I understand that there is a history of taking fossil fuels out of the ground and that is your priority in this moment.

The moment is changing. Look to the future. Think about children. Think about the planet. You can do it and there is space for you. The people who are running National Grid you have expertise. You have valuable skills. Start using them for public good instead of for private greed. Thank you.

(John): Thank you (Sade). Thank you for your comments. Operator can we get the next caller?

Coordinator: That comes from (Santosh Nandabalan). Your line is open. Please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Santosh Nandabalan): Yes (Santosh Nandabalan). I live at zip code 11225 and I am with Food & Water Action. This whole setup seems ridiculous to me. You have to fill out a form to then download an extension on chrome to be directed to call-in number.

I mean I have been on multiple meetings working from home now that we have been doing that for the past week plus. And all of them you have a schedule and an easy way to see who you are talking to and connect with others.

It seems absurd to me that it is so inaccessible and we are getting this at the last minute on how to join in. Really the comments have been said. The (CLCPA), the problems with climate, the problem with how this treats people but this whole process has been not transparent by National Grid.

And frankly, it shows really the level of mistrust we really have for this company. It kind of goes forward. Governor Cuomo needs to take heed of this as well. It is time to move to public power.

It is clear if we don't like there is going to be this continual push of frack gas projects. There is like a complete disregard of public health, of public safety, of climate. Of just basic human decency really.

So really pitiful of this company, National Grid. And moreover we need to stop building out all this fossil fuel infrastructure and ensure we have a real transition to 100% renewable energy. That is now mandated by a state climate law.

So I hope that is really heard. Going forward I hope there is a real postponement of these hearings as we are in this crisis with the coronavirus. And a real seriousness to the climate crisis we are in. Please stop all these track ass proposals. Move to energy efficiency, move to renewable energy. It is the only way to save the children and save our future.

(John): Thank you (Santosh). I appreciate your comments. And operator could we get the next caller please?

Coordinator: Up next is (Jenn) and please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Jenn): Hi can you hear me?

Man: Yes madam. Is it (Jenn)?

(Jenn): Yes this is (Jenn) and my zip code is 11237. I don't really have an affiliation except for I live near the North Brooklyn Pipeline that National Grid is putting into my community.

I just would like to say that I hate that I don't have a choice but to be a customer of National Grid by living in Brooklyn. These are for-profit companies that put greed and profit over the health and safety of the general public including myself.

I recently learned that National Grid CEO makes $4000 an hour. So while we have been sitting on this call, he has made at least $12,000 which I find really appalling. I also find appalling that we are having this meeting during a global pandemic and that these fossil fuel pipelines are steaming ahead during this pandemic.

So I am reiterating everything that has been said on this call. I just really hope that it really sinks in for you and that you are really listening. And that you are really feeling the weight that this has on our society, on our communities, on – if you have children on their children if they have children.

I would like to have children one day but with the climate crisis on the horizon I don't really feel like that is a good decision on my end to do that. And then really disappointed that the public service commission just doesn't seem to be prioritizing the needs of my community or other communities that are impacted by fossil fuel pipelines.

It is really clear that we need to transition now in a just way to renewable energy. And I would love to see leadership on your end to make that happen. And I really wish that you could respond right now because this is super frustrating. We have Zoom but you are not using it.

And yes I want to reiterate that what everyone else has said. Access to this has been really challenging. And I am in my 30s and I am very fluid with

technology but this was rough. I hope that sinks in really, really hard for you. Thank you.

Oh also fracking is banned in New York State. And Mayor de Blasio just declared a ban on all new fossil fuel infrastructure. But for some reason National Grid gets the green light and that doesn't make any sense.

(John): Okay thank you (Jenn). Thank you for your comments. Operator next call please.

Coordinator: Next up I was not able to get the name. No name was recorded. If you could please unmute your line and introduce your line into the conference with your affiliation and zip code.

(Sheila): This is (Sheila) guys. At 10027. I am with United for Action and Food & Water Watch.

(John): Yes (Sheila) I can hear you. Thank you.

(Sheila): Okay it is absolutely appalling that you were giving any consideration to fossil fuel infrastructure projects given the climate legislation about moving to 100% renewables (unintelligible) community vulnerability to the toxic effects of fracking and fossil fuel especially methane pollution (unintelligible) water and soil.

I mean this is a health crisis as well as a climate crisis. And the major proposals somebody referred to natural gas renewability as something (unintelligible). That is like listening to a Trump press conference. This isn't at all possible. There is no such thing and the (unintelligible) pipeline must be shut down immediately. No new gas infrastructure.

The only development has to be in renewables. I don't have time to give all the testimony I gave the past six years when all of these types of projects that I thought by now you have enough record of them. I am appalled that they should talk about yes we will dredge up the land under the water and kill the (unintelligible) and kill the fish.

And that was a given as necessary part of the project. This is appalling. I think we need to go to public (unintelligible) right now. (Unintelligible) and we absolutely not invest anything in fossil fuel infrastructure. Did you hear what I had to say?

(John): Yes madam I just wasn't sure if you were done. Thank you (Sheila). Next caller please.

Coordinator: Up next is (Annie Wilson). Please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Annie Wilson): Hi well I have been trying to get a comment in over and over and over again after each of the films. I had a comment earlier. I will repeat it. This is not a time to be expanding infrastructure and I was asking about the morality of this initiative.

And in addition to that what has National Grid done to reduce the demand? So I am repeating that (unintelligible) hasn't been on the call a couple of hours ago. So my question at the moment now in the larger picture of things was more information especially with the LNG and what would be the exports?

What is the projected percentage of the exports to be fueled through the system? That is my question. Thank you.

(John): Thank you Annie. Operator could we go to the next call please?

Coordinator: Up next is (Margo). Please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Margo): Hi I am (Margo) with Extinction Rebellion. I am a ra/ payer in Greenpoint, Brooklyn. My zip code is 11222.

I know that we are now restricted to comment not questions. But there really wasn't a way to ask you a question not specifically related to one of your videos. So I wanted to ask you human to human how you feel living in this pandemic as we speak virtually to one another inadequately but (unintelligible).

And your workers are working side by side and holes in the ground far too close to one another. And then going back out into our North Brooklyn community possibly spreading the virus.

I mean I know my grocery store manager is really fretting the safety of his cashiers. He is in it and he looks like a deer in the headlights. He is really kind of panicked about it. He is thinking about it.

So how do you feel being sheltered and safe as your workers are building this pipeline in severely unsafe conditions? The workers in the North Brooklyn Pipeline are your responsibility.

And I wonder if you are comfortable with it? I know you don't intend to answer questions in this part of the call but I hope you ask yourselves this question tonight at home with your families and picture your workers at home with their families. And just think for a minute about what you personally may have just condemned them to.

Thank you for letting me ask the question. I hope you spend some time tonight asking yourself the same question.

(John): Thank you (Margo). And thank you for your comments and your questions. And we will take into account all the considerations and questions that were asked today so thank you.

Operator next caller please?

Coordinator: That is from (Nikita Scott). Please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Nikita Scott): (Nikita Scott), Surfrider Foundation, New York City, 10002. I am testifying today on behalf of myself and the several thousand Surfrider Foundation New York City community. We are opposed to the (unintelligible) pipeline and the millions of people who are part of the Surfrider Foundation Network nationally and all possession through climate change and the threat to our environment and ocean.

Firstly, I would like to state that the process of hosting these meetings virtually is unacceptable and (unintelligible) current situation. And further emphasizes inequity of this process with people now being unable to participate.

And disregards the disproportional impact of the pandemic on vulnerable populations many of which are frontline communities and are begin deprived of this opportunity to have their voices heard.

This meeting should have been postponed to allow equitable access. The result of insufficient outreach and notification done throughout these hearings

and update the community on the process. This is in contrary to the (unintelligible) between National Grid and the Public Service Commission which pledged to be open and transparent.

I have been on conference calls all day, every day and I have never needed three devices to participate. And if that is an expectation here is absolutely ridiculous.

I can't see who else is on here. How many people are waiting to speak and you may not be able to. I don't know if you are screening calls. And we are unable to participate fully with the way that this call is set up. And I am sure that compliance is in place to allow a fair open and transparent system.

The news report issued by National Grid is 116 pages long yet still manages to omit critical facts (unintelligible) include and grossly inflate gas demand projections which energy information administration provides.

The projections that National Grid shows actually are also in context to their very own historical trends that shows that gas use is declining. It is irresponsible to be risking the future, all of our communities, the health of our waterways and economic value.

And New York State is actually a $23 billion economy and marine live and (unintelligible) communities that we derive from recreational use of our ocean and our communities on a basis of an inaccurate and shoddy document that doesn't even meet the needs of having National Grid's given quality of work and their fact checking. And it certainly does not meet the need – it certainly does not show the need for more fossil fuel infrastructures.

And same with National Grid's inability to report back to National Grid understates the (unintelligible) pipeline's climate impact. The claims that (unintelligible) pipeline could achieve significant greenhouse gas savings by preventing customers from using (unintelligible) fossil fuels have been disproven.

And for New York (unintelligible) the state climate laws, 85% of the (unintelligible) pipeline would need to be avoided.

Additionally, National Grid is using a 100-year assessment on methane admissions when they need to be using a 20-year scale. National Grid is planning on charging $1.4 billion to rate payers for a project that will be in service for a decade at most.

The (unintelligible) Pipeline and (unintelligible) state climate laws cannot coexist. It is scientifically impossible. So National Grid needs to make it known to the rate payer that they are going to be paying for a $1.4 billion (unintelligible) asset.

When it comes to our health and safety of our future and our communities there is no room for error or emission. It is one thing to have two sites (unintelligible) but there really is only one truth and I urge National Grid to start telling it.

I would like to ask for National Grid stop wasting our time which is also extremely valuable. I testified at multiple preamble hearings, multiple legislative hearings.

This (unintelligible) pipeline has been stopped before. I would like (unintelligible) all levels to oppose it. The people oppose it. So when are we

going to stop (unintelligible) because environmental movement isn't going anywhere and I strongly encourage National Grid to stop wasting our time.

Stop wasting the precious time that we have left to respond to climate change and pivot the efforts and attention towards developing and implementing clean renewable energy solutions that are based on the truth. Are actually factually significantly important and are going to be such instrumental innovations for the future of our planet. Thank you.

(John): Thank you (Nikita). Thank you for your comments. I think there are a few more in the queue operator. So could we get next call please?

Coordinator: Yes. That is from Alexandra Hodkowski. Your line is open. Please state your affiliation and zip code.

Alexandra Hodkowski: Hi yes this is Alexandra Hodkowski. I am a resident of Brooklyn and a National Grid customer. I agree with everybody. This format is not ideal at all. Similar to the format that was presented to us when we went to the public hearing and all of a sudden it became private and I had to go into a private room. We have got to figure out a better way for these. It is possible.

I wanted to mention to one point out of many that National Grid's report also says nothing about the financial risk of the pipeline to rate payers. National Grid doesn't mention the chances of the (unintelligible) Pipeline becoming a stranded asset.

(Unintelligible) would be expected to last until around 2070. Yet state climate law mandates net zero emissions by 2050 and Local Law 97 will reduce big building emissions 40% by 2030.

Gas use will plummet during that time making the pipeline obsolete well before its intended retirement date. National Grid fails to include (externized) costs in its assessment, the social cost of contributing to the climate crisis and the environmental cost of building a 23-mile pipeline through New York Harbor would be significant and yet are entirely left out.

Listen Governor Cuomo we do not want this. And please listen National Grid. This is not the right option. We need to figure out renewable energy. Thank you.

(John): Thank you Alexandra. Operator next call please?

Coordinator: That is from (Eric) please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Eric): Hello. I am from 10031 I am affiliated with Patagonia and the Citizens Climate Lobby. I was looking over the planned proposal and the thing that really stuck out to me is not so much that there is going to be another pipeline.

I mean it is not something I fully support whatsoever. But that National Grid seemed to not put any effort in trying to create any more palatable to the people that might oppose it.

While it might exist until 2070 there is a good chance it won't and there seems to be no proposal to once this thing is actually defunct or once we actually have to stop bringing natural gas. There is not seemly any plan to dredge it back up and to promptly remove it and any possible pain that it might inflict on the national environment.

There also seems to be no plan in place of we are going to do any dredging or remediation of the local wildlife while we put this in to make it at least safer.

It seems to me more of just we are going to dig up a hole and lay down a pipeline.

The other thing that is interesting to me is that the revenue that could be created from this is the perfect opportunity to invest in energy efficiency for ConEd and National Grid and a perfect opportunity to invest in renewable energy and invest in better R&D for the future.

But that also seems to be a little shortsighted and it seems mostly just a little bit of a cynical (unintelligible). I do hope I am wrong on that specific occasion. Mostly I feel like you could have made this more palatable to people who might be opposing it by putting in more of a responsible corporate response in your fully proposed plan.

But it doesn't seem like I see any of that. Maybe that is because it would cost too much. Whatever. But if you really wanted to install more infrastructure in your grid system, I would have felt that it would have been better served putting in renewables or working with the local community to actually give them what they wanted.

We do have plenty of natural gas as it is. I don't fully see that this is that much of an issue to be putting in another pipeline. I don't really like it. I don't really think we need it. And again I think that this plan could have looked a lot better if you had decided to put some of the revenue that you made into these other avenues. Thanks.

(John): Thank you (Eric). Operator next caller please?

Man: Hey (John) we have two more callers. We will extend the call to hear these two and these will be the last two comments we will hear this evening.

(John): Okay thank you.

Coordinator: Up next is (Stephanos). Please state your affiliation and zip code.

(Stephanos): My name is (Stephanos). I am a Rockaway resident and my zip code is 11692. I think it is kind of a travesty that National Grid is considering holding a public hearing appropriate in these uncertain economic and political and environmental times.

Most people that this affects the most can't make it to this meeting tonight. They have other priorities right now. There are people that have lost their job. They don't know where their next paycheck is coming from. Whose kids are driving them crazy at home.

And the last thing that they can do right now is muster up the time and energy and effort to attend a virtual public hearing. So while I do applaud the social distancing measures as responsible. You know you are kind of hiding behind your finger.

I would also like to speak to the natural resource that is Gateway National Recreation area. It is a 26,000-acre park. It is the largest park on the Northeast. It encompasses Monmouth County in New Jersey.

The Fort Wadsworth and Great Kills unit in Staten Island and Jamaica Bay unit in Brooklyn and Queens is a huge national asset and in a time of social distancing, in a time where the vaccine isn't going to be available to another 12 to 18 months. And I know the construction probably won't start until after that.

But like you have got to be out of your noggin if you are suggesting that you put that resource – if you are planning on compromising that resource in any way, shape or form.

And just because you have shut up the more conservative maybe Republican leaning communities by giving their little leagues and their soccer teams money to buy jerseys and certain non-profits in the area have, you know, they have taken your donations so that they don't speak out against you.

You know we have a word for that in English. It is called bribery. Just because it is legal. Just because you are doing it in a legal fashion doesn't change the fact that it is bribery. You know.

So cut the crap and get lost. Thanks.

(John): All right operator could we get the next caller please?

Coordinator: The next caller did not record their name. If you could please unmute your phone and state your name into the conference with your affiliation and zip code.

Man: Looks like they dropped and that was the last caller in queue.

(John): All right so operator thank you very much. So let me just say at this point thank you all for joining us tonight. We did hear your comments. And again I just want to repeat what I said at the start that again with the coronavirus we wanted to both be respectful of social distancing.

But also be respectful to have the opportunity, to give you the opportunity to share your comments and hear about the options. So while I think one of the

comments that it wasn't optimal. We certainly would have liked to have an in-person meeting but one could certainly imagine that is just not an opportunity right now.

But your comments have all been recorded. You know this was – your feedback, your questions that were collected here tonight are a very valuable part of this public input process.

We plan to use all this information in a supplemental report that will come out in April that will reflect the public input that we received. Also enable and agree to long term solution or solutions with New York State by June of 2020.

So thank you for your input tonight. The timeline will enable a solution or solutions to be in place by the winter of '21, '22. And as a reminder, you know a number of people had asked for more time and opportunity to submit questions or comment.

As a reminder if you have any input that you did not have a chance to put in tonight. Please provide it directly to New York State Public Service Commission. You could do so at the Web site that has been cited. It is on our Web site as well.

We have instructions for doing so on the report Web site as well. So that concludes tonight's report. Thank you for joining us during some very difficult times in our society. So thank you very much and have a safe night.

Operator you can close the call.

Coordinator: Thank you. That does conclude today's conference call. We appreciate your participation. You may now disconnect. Speakers please stand by for your post conference.

END